The Source of Mindfulness: A Commentary on the Difficult Points of the Great King of Tantras Called Hevajra, the Illusion in Two Parts

Hevajranāmamahātantrarājadvikalpamāyāsyapañcikasmṛtinipadanāma · Toh 1187 · Derge Tengyur

རྡོ་རྗེ་གཞུ་པ་ཚོན་པ་དོག་སྟེ་པའ་རི་རྩེ་ཟླ་བ་བྱ་སྐ་ཐམ་པ་གཉའ་པའ་དེ་ཀའ་འགའ་ལྟེ་དབུ་པའ་ལེབ་བྱ་གཏན་ཞེས་བ་བྱ

The Source of Mindfulness, known in full as The Commentary on the Difficult Points of the Great King of Tantras Called Hevajra, the Illusion in Two Parts (Sanskrit Smṛtinipada; Tibetan Drenpé Jungné), is a brief commentary on the Hevajra Tantra by the Indian master Kṛṣṇa, who says he wrote it so that the words of the tantra might be kept in mind. After setting out the customary preliminaries of the work's expression, subject matter, connection and purpose, it moves through the chapters of both parts of the tantra, glossing key lines and drawing out their meaning: the deities of the Hevajra maṇḍala and what each feature of their forms stands for in its purity, the union of method and wisdom and the innate bliss it reveals, the graded teaching of the philosophical schools that leads a student on to Hevajra, the decoding of the tantra's concealed mantras letter by letter, and the signs that show which buddha family a practitioner belongs to. It is Toh 1187 in the Tengyur, where it is classed among the tantra commentaries, and its colophon records that it was translated into Tibetan by an Indian preceptor together with the great Tibetan translator Gö Lhetsé.

In the language of India: hevajra nāma mahātantrarāja dvikalpamāyāsya pañcika smṛtinipada nāma

In the language of Tibet: The Commentary on the Difficult Points of the Great King of Tantras called Hevajra, the Illusion in Two Parts, entitled The Source of Mindfulness.

Homage to the Blessed One Hevajra.

Bowing to the vajra master, the great guru,
And to Heruka, the glorious protector,
This brief work that clarifies the words of Hevajra
I write down so that it may be kept in mind.

First of all, in order to draw in those who are discerning, I shall state the expression, the subject matter, the connection, the purpose, and the purpose

of the purpose. Of these, the body of text beginning "Thus have I heard" is the expression. The Blessed One, glorious Heruka, Nairātmyā (Selflessness), and the others are the subject matter. That these stand in the characteristic relation of expression and subject matter is the connection. The purpose is this: with entry into the maṇḍala and so forth as the preliminary, all obscurations are completely destroyed, and the three bodies, whose nature is unsurpassed great bliss, are spontaneously perfected. The purpose of the purpose is to bring to perfection, for all the immeasurable sentient beings who dwell in saṃsāra, the aims of higher rebirth and definitive goodness, just as each of them wishes. As it is said:

Perfect benefit for others is held to be
The chief and supreme fruit of a buddha;
Were it otherwise, there would be no buddhas and so forth.
Therefore that is declared to be its fruit.

At the outset, in order to show five points, namely what, when, where, from whom, and together with whom, the compiler says "Thus" and so on. "Thus" is in its nature the whole meaning of the tantra that follows, and it is to be connected with "heard." "I" means: not someone else, and not from someone else. "Heard" means that it was apprehended by the auditory consciousness, not that it was realized through direct perception. "At one time" means that at one time this was heard, while at other times other things were heard; this shows that the compiler had heard a great deal. "The Blessed One" means the one whose very nature is the awakening mind.

If one asks where it was heard: "in the bhagas of the vajra consorts of the body, speech, and mind of all the tathāgatas." "Tathāgatas" means the tathāgatas who are taught to be immeasurable. "Body, speech, and mind" means the bodhisattvas, who are taught as threefold through the distinction of Kāyavajra (Body Vajra) and the others. "Vajra consorts" means the yoginīs, and their bhaga is the palace whose very nature is wisdom. If one asks from whom it was heard: from that very Blessed One, that is, from the Vajra Bearer of the single nature of all phenomena. If one asks with whom: together with all the tathāgatas such as Vairocana, the bodhisattvas such as Kāyavajra, and the yoginīs such as Nairātmyā.

It may be objected: "This is not tenable. How is it not tenable? All these opening words were not made manifest by the perfect Buddha." It is not so, for the Blessed One himself taught at length in words such as "I am the

expounder." Again, it may be said: "The Blessed One thoroughly turned the wheel of Dharma and passed into nirvāṇa." It is not so. Precisely because his is the non-abiding nirvāṇa, the Blessed One continually appears; and since he teaches the Dharma in various forms and various languages, in accordance with each one's fortune, it is not possible that he has passed entirely into final nirvāṇa. As it is said:

The Buddha does not pass into nirvāṇa,
Nor does the Dharma decline.

He is presented as a certain compiler. It is with this intention that "dwells" is said: in keeping with the many particular dispositions of those to be trained, he dwells in the four postures.

In the passage beginning "Thus have I heard," "dwells" means that he dwells endowed with miraculous powers and miraculous displays of many kinds. "All the tathāgatas" are Vairocana and the others; their body, speech, and mind are vajra because they are indivisible. For the sake of taming, that very vajra is made into consorts, and their bhaga is the palace in harmony with the teaching of the Dharma that is higher than the highest. "The Blessed One" is to be construed as before. Here, because there is both conquest and endowment, he is the Bhagavān:

Glory, fame, and wisdom,
Sovereignty and beauty of form,
And diligence, possessed in perfection:
These six are reckoned as conquest.

So it is said. Again, it is conquest because of vanquishing, since the foe, the four kinds of māra, has been vanquished. As it is said:

Through wisdom the afflictions are abandoned;
Therefore wisdom is called conquest.

If one asks in what way the Blessed One is distinguished: the passage "Thus have I heard" is completed by "attained from the four abodes of Brahmā." Relying on common usage, this is given in the neuter gender. As it is said:

Because he destroyed the two obscurations,
The fourfold abode of Brahmā,
In the time of a single instant,
The Blessed One made manifest.

So it is said, and others here explain it as: "who, through these, whose nature is the immeasurables, presided over all mindstreams and directly realized full comprehension through the wisdom of omniscience."

Again, "Thus" is the Teacher endowed with the thirty-two major marks, the Lord who possesses the eighty minor marks. "I" means the mind of desire. "Heard" means what is taught. "At one time" means on one occasion. "The Blessed One" is the conventional awakening mind, which appears like a kunda flower (white jasmine). "The body, speech, and mind of all the tathāgatas" are these; although these very ones are vajra by way of nonconceptual meditative absorption, that very vajra is the consort for the sake of those to be trained through great desire. Its bhaga is that which has the form of e, and he abides in that palace. "Dwells" means that he abides in order to benefit those to be trained through great desire.

As it is said:

The Teacher with the thirty-two major marks,
The Lord who possesses the eighty minor marks,
In the consort's bhaga, in great bliss,
Truly abides in the form of semen.
Without realizing it, there is no bliss;
Bliss forsaken, it is insubstantial and is not.

That is what others say.

Again, "Thus" is the Dharma body (dharmakāya). "I" is the enjoyment body (saṃbhogakāya). "Heard" is the emanation body (nirmāṇakāya). "At one time" refers to the arising of the innate (sahaja). "The Blessed One" is the nature of great bliss in which the three bodies are indivisible. The words "dwells in the bhaga of the vajra consort of the body, speech, and mind of all the tathāgatas" mean that he is endowed with abiding. As it is said:

In the bhaga of the excellent vajra consort,
Which has the nature of e,
The jewel casket of the buddhas,
In Sukhāvatī (the Land of Bliss), there he dwells.

I am the expounder, I am also the Dharma,
I am the listener, together with my own assembly.

So it is said. "I am the expounder" refers to the enjoyment body. "I am also the Dharma" is the nature of the Dharma that is to be realized in the manner of

the Dharma body. "I am the listener, together with my own assembly" refers to the emanation body.

The condensed meaning here is this: within the palace of the source of phenomena (dharmodaya), the Blessed One, who embodies the three bodies, abides as their very nature in the minds of all the tathāgatas, bodhisattvas, and yoginīs, for as long as saṃsāra lasts. The lord Vajrasattva, who has become the cause, is the Dharma body. The great Vajradhara, lord of the maṇḍala together with its deities, is the enjoyment body. And all those who act in various ways for the welfare of beings in the ten directions are of the nature of the emanation body. As it is said:

Vajradharma and the buddhas,
The yoginīs and the mātṛkās (mother goddesses).

The meaning of this is as follows: "Vajradharma" is the Dharma body; likewise "the buddhas" is the enjoyment body; "the mātṛkās" is the emanation body. Such is the explanation of the words beginning "Thus" according to the sequence of the instructions handed down from one to another.

Now, regarding the passage beginning "the Blessed One," to the question, "Why, then, is it set forth that the Blessed One spoke without having been asked?" others reply: "Because this tantra in two parts came from within the Hevajra in thirty-two parts. Since there, at the beginning, the request by the retinue and so forth were spoken, all this is well established." If they say this, they are not correct, because it is explained by way of the opening words beginning "Thus," and because in the Ḍākinī Vajra Net, too, Vajragarbha is shown to be the permanent embodiment of the primordial full awakening. Moreover, the Blessed One, through his mantra body, constantly and effortlessly engages in the welfare of others. Since through it he fully teaches the mindstreams of the people to be trained, each in accordance with their own fortune, what would a requester and the like have to do here? It is also said:

O, O vajra ḍākinīs,
That reality which I have kept secret,
To which all the buddhas pay homage,
Through the blessing of the vajra offering,
I shall explain as you wish: listen!

In the passage beginning "all the tathāgatas," "all the tathāgatas" are those described as equal to space. Whatever is their body, speech, and mind is "the

essence," because it is nonconceptual. Of what kind is it? It is "venerable," because it delivers those who are devoted. In the phrase "supremely secret, even beyond the secret," "the secret" is the vajrayoginīs, because they are utterly hidden even from the śrāvakas and others. What is supremely secret even beyond that is glorious Heruka himself, whose nature is the Dharma body; because he is the very means for the welfare of others, he is called "the essence." "Hevajra" is by nature nonreferential compassion and wisdom: "Listen to that!"

The passage beginning "Who is Vajrasattva?": these words are spoken after a request has been made. In the passage beginning "indivisible," "vajra" is the mind. "The three realms of existence become one" means through nonconceptuality itself. "Wisdom" is the mudrā. This is to be connected with "union," up to "entering into union." "This" is said because it abides in the intellect. Alternatively, "by this" means without a referent. "By union with wisdom" means through nonconceptuality itself. This shows the Dharma body.

In the passage beginning "great primordial wisdom," "primordial wisdom" is the embodiment of method and wisdom. It is "great" because those at the culmination of the continuum, endowed with the perfection of merit and primordial wisdom, swiftly bring those who have not attained full awakening to its completion. Its taste is unsurpassed great bliss, and he is filled with it. This shows the enjoyment body.

In the passage beginning "always," "always" means at all times. "The pledge" means those to be trained. He is "engaged" because he accomplishes, all at once, their worldly and transworldly aims. This shows the emanation body in brief.

In the passage beginning "He," compassion is kāruṇa: in this, kā is bliss and ru is holding. Toward all the different kinds, without exception, of space, of destinies, and of places of birth, or else toward all sentient beings, whether friends, enemies, or those in between, it engages equally, without objectifying them and without hope of any benefit in return; because it is thus magnanimous, it is "great." "Wisdom" is that whose nature is entirely unerring. That which teaches it is also given this name, just as a volume of the Perfection of Wisdom is also called "the Perfection of Wisdom." That which is by nature wisdom and method is the tantra.

In the passage beginning "gazes," the gazes are the felling gaze and the others. Summoning is drawing in. The great signs are the conventions of body

and speech used by the yoginīs. Power is capability. The rest is simply easy to understand.

In the passage beginning "of the yoginīs," "the manner in which" means the rite as it actually is. The seed that is transformed after all the tathāgatas have first been drawn into it is the cause of generation. After that, the seed abiding in the heart, which radiates compassion in order to dispel the suffering of all sentient beings, is the cause of abiding. Further, "power" means miraculous power. "Wisdom" is reality. "Consciousness" means the vajra sciences and the like. "The deities" are the forms of Heruka. "How they arise" means that they are to be generated as explained before.

In the passage beginning "first," "one" is the form of Vajrasattva, which at the outset embodies the five full awakenings. "The cause of generating Heruka" is said by way of illustration: it is also the cause of the yoginīs.

In the passage beginning "by existence itself": the form of glorious Heruka, a body contrary to the ordinary, whose nature is unsurpassed awakening, and in which the people to be trained have deep faith, is "existence"; through it they become liberated. In "they are bound by the bonds of existence," "existence" means the aggregates and so forth, which are erroneous; that itself is the bond, and they are bound by it. That is the meaning. In "if that is fully understood, one becomes liberated," "that" is existence: when it is fully understood, one becomes completely liberated from apprehended object and apprehending subject. If one asks why this is so, since it is existence that binds: it is because the very existence of saṃsāra is the cause of nirvāṇa.

In "Therefore existence should be meditated upon," "existence" is the deities whose nature is method and wisdom, and "should be meditated upon" means that they should be thoroughly cultivated. In "nonexistence too, fully," "nonexistence" is the nature of unsurpassed great bliss, because its nature is free of the two. The meaning is that this very thing is to be realized by way of self-awareness. In "likewise Heruka," the meaning is that one should meditate on the nature of all things and one's own body, speech, and mind as nondual. In "Nonexistence is full understanding," it is called nonexistence because existence itself is meditated upon nonconceptually. As it is said:

Taking color as a thing, one falls,
And likewise through nonexistence.
Knowing existence, one is wholly freed,
And likewise through nonexistence.

In the passage beginning "dwelling in the body," "dwelling in the body" is with a referent: it is what the tathāgatas have inspired. "Great wisdom" is without referent: it is of the nature of what the great Vajradhara inspires. "Free of all conceptual thought" means by way of nonconceptual meditative absorption. "The self that pervades all things" means by way of acting for the welfare of all beings. "Though dwelling in the body" means though it dwells in the Dharma body, the enjoyment body, and the emanation body. "It is not born of the body," because there is nothing else that surpasses it.

Alternatively, "dwelling in the body" is of a vast nature, characterized as enjoyment and emanation. "Great wisdom" is the embodiment of method and wisdom without referent. "Free of all conceptual thought," because the nature of conceptual thought has entirely subsided. "The self that pervades all things": being unobstructed and equal to the unequalled, it is like space; it is the Dharma body, which pervades all phenomena and whose nature is supremely profound. "Though dwelling in the body" means though it appears in the form of a body. "It is not born of the body" means that it is not established as a body: although the Teacher appears to those to be trained in this form or that, according to their fortune, he is not actually so.

On the passage beginning "the Indivisible One":

Because the three vajras are indivisible,
She is renowned as the Indivisible One (Abhedyā).
Through divisions such as a hair's tip,
She is declared to be subtle.
Because she is bound by matter,
She herself is rightly taught to be the one with form.
Since she arises from the body,
She is taught to be the Excellent One.
She who circles by the left
Is called the Left One (Vāmā).
The goddess who is always curved
Is called the Curving One (Vāminī).
She who is born in the manner of a turtle
Is called the Turtle-born (Kūrmajā).
The existence that abides in existence
Is here called She of Existence (Bhāvakī).
Because she washes everywhere,
The wise proclaim her the Anointing One (Sekā).

Because she brings the afflictions to ruin,
She is taught to be She of Faults (Doṣavatī).
She who sows into the body
Is surely declared to be the Sower.
Because she accords with a mother,
She is always held to be the Mother Goddess (Mātṛkā).
Since she goes everywhere,
She is rightly taught to be the Universal One.
Since she gives coolness, she is the Giver of Coolness (Śītadā);
Since she gives heat, she is the Warm One (Ūṣmā).
Because her nature knows no contentment,
She is renowned as Woman (Lalanā).
By way of the absence of intrinsic nature,
She is taught to be the Dispeller of Evil (Avadhūtī).

Because she bestows all flavors,
She is likewise called the Essence of Savor (Rasanā).
She whose form is like the moon
Is taught by the learned to be called the Measure.
She is taught to be the Fair-Faced (Surūpiṇī).
By way of dense black darkness,
She is taught to be the Dark-Hued One (Kṛṣṇavarṇā).
Since she joins the mind in equality,
She is declared to be the Common One (Sāmānyā).
As she bestows every cause in full,
She is called the Giver of Causes (Hetudāyikā).
Because she is parted from the cause of suffering,
Here she is declared to be the Parted One (Viyogā).
By way of being bound fast by attachment,
She is taught to be the Loving One (Premaṇī).
Because delightful desires are accomplished,
She is renowned as the Accomplished One (Siddhā).
Because she has the nature of the element of fire,
She is taught to be the Fiery One (Pāvakī).
Being by nature the element of water,
She is called the Most Delightful (Sumanā).
She who is coiled in three ways

Is taught to be called the Thrice-Coiled One (Trivṛtā).
Because she possesses every desire,
She is held to be called the Desirous One of the Wind (Kāminī).
Being spoken of as the owner of the house,
She is then taught to be the Householder (Gehā).
The goddess who abides in fierce actions
Is taught to be called the Fierce One (Caṇḍikā).
Because she is youthful and fickle,
She is held to be the Daughter of Māra (Māradārikā).

These very ones are presented individually in the fourth chapter of the second part, by these lines:
"On the channels, two by two, the goddesses
Are to be placed in order, one each."

"The three entities are transformed": this is through attaining the nature of enlightened body, speech, and mind. "Free of grasped and grasper": this is from the standpoint of the ultimate. In the passage beginning "Or else," the words "or else, all" refer to these. Because they are accompanied by the presiding mind, they have the characteristic of entities; that is, they have become the domain of the realizing intellect, conceived as the cause of bliss.

On "I shall explain the divisions of the vow": it is a vow because it restrains from all bad views. "Divisions" means being distinguished; that is, this very vow is superior to the paths of the hearers (śrāvakas) and the rest. The term āli kāli means that which brings all qualities without exception to completion, namely the sets of vowels and consonants. "Wisdom" means realizing all conceptual elaborations as having the intrinsic nature of lacking any essential nature. "Method" is great compassion. "Dharma, enjoyment, and emanation" are their results. "Body, speech, and mind" are the means of accomplishment. The words evaṃ mayā refer to the four goddesses who are the purity of the elements of the four syllables, characterized by loving-kindness, compassion, joy, and equanimity. The passage beginning "the emanation wheel" sets out the number of the wheels; they are presented individually in the third chapter of the second part, by the passage beginning "Variety."

On the passage beginning "The Four Noble Truths are": if one asks what the so-called Four Noble Truths are, they are "suffering" and the rest. Suffering is, by nature, the consciousness, name and form, six sense sources, contact,

feeling, birth, and aging and death of the three realms; it should be fully understood. It is the origin, since suffering arises from it in full; it consists of ignorance, formations, craving, and becoming, and it should be abandoned. Cessation is the utter non-arising of the aggregates, sense sources, and elements accompanied by defilements, of the mind and mental factors that make up both the adverse side and the antidote; it should be realized in direct perception. The path is the meditation preceded by becoming free of attachment to the three realms, whose nature accords with abandoning the afflictions, and which serves as the antidote known as impermanence, suffering, emptiness, and selflessness; it should be cultivated. This, moreover, is what will be explained below with the words, "Then explain the Vaibhāṣika."

Alternatively, the aggregates of the three realms are suffering because they possess the three sufferings, those of conditioning, of change, and of suffering; this is to be understood. The five aggregates of appropriation, which have become the support and the supported, together with the habitual tendencies conjoined with karma and afflictions, are the origin, since suffering arises from them in full; they are to be abandoned. The form of the deity, free of all conceptual elaborations and of the nature of unsurpassed method and wisdom, is cessation; it is to be actualized. The stainless meditative absorption of method and wisdom, which is the inseparability of emptiness and compassion preceded by the purity of the deity that serves as the antidote to the ordinary form, and which is endowed with the capacity for the perfect aims of higher rebirth and definitive goodness, is the path; it is to be cultivated.

"The reality of the self" means being empty. On "the reality of mantra": because it considers and reflects, it is ma, which is mind; tra is protection, which is compassion. What is sent forth for the benefit of sentient beings is the reality of mantra. "The reality of the deity": the purity of the deities through mirror-like primordial wisdom and the others is the reality of the deity. "The reality of primordial wisdom" is nondual primordial wisdom; because it is unerring, it is reality.

The passage beginning "The four joys are" states them; this very topic will be explained individually in the eighth chapter, by the passage beginning "Joy is a little bliss." "The four schools" too is merely stated; it will be explained individually in the fourth chapter of the second part, by the passage beginning "The emanation wheel is the Sthavira."

From "moon and sun" up to "watches," the teaching is given through the division of day and night, and so it teaches the purity of the four wheels that are of the nature of mantra. "Moon and sun" is the division into night and day. The term āli kāli is the division into method and wisdom, with respect to night and day. Of these, the wheels of the heart and the head are the moon and method; the wheels of the navel and the throat are day and wisdom. On "the sixteen transitions (saṃkrānti)": this is the proper transition of the winds; that is, the light of primordial wisdom, whose nature is wisdom, mounts the chariot of the wind and properly transits into the channels two by two. "The sixteen transitions of time" applies to the day and night. The wheel of complete enjoyment has sixteen petals because it is the purity of the sixteen transitions. The emanation wheel has sixty-four petals because it is the purity of the sixty-four daṇḍa periods. The wheel of great bliss has thirty-two petals because it is the purity of the thirty-two channel periods.

"The four watches" applies to the day and the night: the wheel of Dharma has eight petals because it is the purity of the two sets of four periods. "All of these are in fours" means that everything beginning from evaṃ mayā is fourfold.

In the passage beginning "At the navel," "navel" means at the center of the sixty-four-petaled lotus of the emanation wheel. The wisdom woman, who has the form of the syllable aṃ, is the Fierce One (Caṇḍālī) because she is untouchable: she cannot be touched by any conceptual thought, and her intrinsic nature is the indivisibility of all phenomena. Because she is endowed with light, she is "blazing"; that is, she has the nature of warmth, smoke, radiating light rays, blazing, and so on. She goes to the center of the eight-petaled wheel of Dharma. "The five Tathāgatas" and "Locanā and the others too" are the conceptual aspects whose nature is the five aggregates and the four great elements; these, in their natural form, have become the hūṃ dwelling at the center of the lotus. "Burned" means that they are fully gathered into a single taste. Just as cloth of many colors, once burned, turns into ash, so conceptions of many kinds are "burned" in that they no longer appear and become the source of nonconceptual primordial wisdom. After that, the sixteen-petaled lotus of the wheel of complete enjoyment becomes the source of supreme joy, and after full dissolution in the manner of the body of complete enjoyment, all the firewood of conceptions is then to be burned without remainder at the site of great bliss. The syllable haṃ is the imperishable, free from all the conceptions of the adverse side. "The hare-marked" is the moon of bodhicitta, whose nature is the nectar of

emptiness and compassion; for as long as saṃsāra lasts, it accomplishes the aims of self and others, and its nature is supreme great bliss. It is the hare-marked one because its parts, the ten powers, the fearlessnesses, the eighteen unshared qualities, and the rest, are complete, and because it is free from the darkness of grasping at self and mine and the like; it is not something else, a common accomplishment whose nature is deluded action.

Some say that the passage beginning "At the navel" was spoken in order to teach the fire offering of the body. On this view, the navel is the hearth. The fire of wisdom, whose nature is self-awareness, is the Fierce One; being driven upward by the wind of union, it is "blazing." "The five Tathāgatas" are the conceptions of the five aggregates, and "burned" means illuminated. "Locanā and the others too" refers to the elements and the sense sources as well; by this, the oblations that consist of the substances of the aggregates and so on are taught. "Burned" refers to all the oblations and firewood without exception; this is to be done for Kāyavajra, endowed with the seed syllable haṃ. The downward-facing haṃ has the nature of the ladle. "Flows" has the nature of the full fire offering (pūrṇāhuti): as the stream of the fluid of bodhicitta descends from it, satisfaction is brought about, and the desired result is bestowed.

On "the chapter of the vajra family": the vajra is mind. That itself is the family, because it has become the intrinsic nature of all phenomena. Its meditative absorption is like a cloth, because it covers and protects the minds of the people to be trained. Because it takes up and holds, that collection of text is the chapter of the vajra family, the first.

This is the explanation of the first chapter from The Source of Mindfulness, the commentary on the difficult points of the Hevajra composed by the master Kṛṣṇa.

To show that without worldly ritual applications sentient beings cannot be brought into the transcendent Dharma, the passage beginning "the chapter on mantras" was spoken. "The chapter on mantras" is the collection of mantras. "I shall explain" means: according to their proper ritual procedures. In order to teach that in all ritual actions, pacifying and the rest, the mantrin should first offer a torma and then begin, the torma mantra is taught first in that chapter on mantras. The mantra beginning akāro mukhaṃ purifies and perfects the torma. After that, in order to teach that in whatever ritual actions of pacifying and the rest, one should meditate in that way and give primacy to first reciting

the corresponding mantra, the seed syllables of the Tathāgatas, beginning with bruṃ, were taught. Because all the purities are taught in this tantra, the Sixteen-Armed One is the principal one; therefore, after that, his mantra was taught, beginning oṃ deva bicu vajra. The rest, those of the two-armed form and the others, were taught for the sake of training disciples. The passage beginning "In all mantra words" teaches the characteristics common to all mantras.

The passage beginning a phuḥ teaches the rite for bringing rain. With the two syllables a phuḥ, one first emanates an image of Ananta; then one draws the maṇḍala according to the oral instructions, and in its center one draws the Sixteen-Armed One trampling Ananta. Some hold that the maṇḍala deities, too, are to be drawn trampling their respective guardians of the directions. After that, the vajra master, having first performed the yoga of the Eight-Faced One, should bring down the rain by reciting the mantra that stirs the nāgas, beginning ghuṭya ghuṭya.

The passage beginning "Vajrā and" means this: for the seven kinds of ritual actions, harming and the rest, one visualizes the seven yoginīs, Vajrā and the others, arising from their own seed syllables and symbolic marks, upon seats, as having a nature endowed with the form, color, and mood that accord with the action; and having visualized them so, one should accomplish them. Killing is taught here in general terms; it will be explained as it is presented individually, with its proper procedures, in other chapters of this same tantra.

This is the explanation of the second chapter from The Source of Mindfulness, the commentary on the difficult points of the Hevajra composed by the master Kṛṣṇa.

To teach that without realizing deity yoga one cannot in any way turn back the ordinary form, the passage beginning "Then, the chapter on the deity" was spoken.

On "First one should cultivate loving-kindness": loving-kindness is the mind that, making no distinction among friends, those in between, and those who have become enemies, fully embraces them with benefit and happiness. On "Second, one should cultivate compassion": compassion is the wish to deliver all sentient beings from the ocean of suffering, without regard even for one's own body and life. On "Third, one should cultivate joy": joy is the thought, held with a mind endowed with tenderness and benevolence, "Through deity yoga, the unsurpassed method that frees all sentient beings from every suffering

without remainder, I have found the path." On "Last of all, equanimity": if one considers that the sufferings of all sentient beings without exception cannot be removed unless the primordial wisdom of omniscience has become manifest, then the thought, "Until it has become manifest, I shall leave sentient beings aside and actualize myself as Heruka, and after that I shall establish them in that very state," is equanimity.

After cultivating the four abodes of Brahmā (brahmavihāras) in this way, one should meditate on what is taught from the passage beginning "In the sky, upon the Venerable Lady" up to "passionately attached with great passion." After that, one should attend to this: "First, the awakening to emptiness." The absence of intrinsic nature in all phenomena is the empty. "Awakening" is the mind. Accordingly, it is ascertained through this mere self-awareness of all mind and mental factors; this is the focus on the mind.

On "In the second, the seed is gathered": it is a seed because it generates everything; it has become the essence of all phenomena and has the characteristics of its appropriate color and so forth. "Gathered" into it means ascertaining the form of the mantra, preceded by causing all the Tathāgatas without exception to enter it; this is the focus on the mantra. On "The third is the perfection of the image": from that seed, the image is perfected and arises in the form of the body of all the Tathāgatas; this is the focus on the body. On "The fourth, of placing": it is placing because things are set in place; the sense sources, the eye and the rest, should be purified by the deities according to the proper application. On "the syllable": it is the syllable (akṣara, the imperishable) because, as the intrinsic nature of all phenomena, it does not change and does not move; the meaning is that one should meditate on the nature of unsurpassed great bliss as being that very jewel of mind.

This very point is taught in the passage beginning "First, repha" (the letter ra). "First one should visualize the corpse" is an illustrative mention: from earth, water, fire, and wind contained within the source of phenomena (dharmodaya), and from oneself fully transformed, one should generate the multistoried mansion together with the corpse seats of the deities in the cardinal and intermediate directions; and at the heart of the central corpse seat is the sun disc arisen from raṃ. "Upon that, the form of hūṃ, of the nature of wisdom and method": this means the discs of moon and sun from the transformation of the vowels and consonants. After that, one visualizes in their center the seed syllable and the symbolic mark; and after that, from all of them becoming one, one should regard oneself as having the nature of the

glorious Heruka Vajrasattva, black in color through the purity of aversion, or else blue and red in color through the complete purity of wisdom and method; and one should regard the two-armed, four-armed, and six-armed embodiments of the supreme one as being like sons.

"That itself is the being (sattva)" means that the Heruka generated first is what is called Vajrasattva. On "of the nature of supreme joy": supreme joy is bodhicitta, and the being has the nature of bringing forth form from it. "Radiating forth" means that from that very great Vajradhara, who has become the cause, emanation bodies of many kinds are emanated to accomplish the aims of all sentient beings. "The light of one's own body" means the respective bodies, colors, and so forth of the yoginīs appearing individually; the respective bodies, colors, moods, and so forth of these are to be learned from the second part. "Covering the sphere of the sky" means pervading it. "Having gathered" means gathering it back in again. "Into the heart" means into one's own seed syllable. "One should cause it to enter" means: having dissolved it, again from the transformation of their own seed syllables and symbolic marks, one should complete in an instant the goddesses, Gaurī and the others, in their proper places on their own seats, with their arms, faces, colors, and shapes just as they are.

After that, one draws in the three syllables set between two hoḥ, which are like a gandharva, the being between death and rebirth; they enter oneself, and one emits them in the form of bodhicitta through the path of the vajra into the lotus. By its power, one should see oneself together with the consort melting together. Then, at the end of the goddesses' exhortation with the four verses that come below, one is to visualize the Blessed One as two-armed, four-armed, and six-armed; this is taught by the passage beginning "The yogin becomes the embodiment of aversion." Because this is the family of the purity of aversion, his head is adorned with Akṣobhya. The others, Gaurī and the rest, should be understood as embodying the purity of the four families. Others, however, say that because it is said below, "When born, he is a monk; his very voice is mantra," one should imagine the innate form with two arms; there is no differentiation of arms, faces, and eyes, and there is neither a consort of one's own nor any maṇḍala deities.

This is the explanation of the third chapter from The Source of Mindfulness, the commentary on the difficult points of the Hevajra composed by the master Kṛṣṇa.

Within the generation stage, the fourth branch is not completed without empowerment; therefore, in order to complete it, the passage beginning "I shall explain the chapter on empowerment" was spoken. "From the seed in one's own heart" means from the seed syllable at the heart of the form of Heruka who has become the result.

"Blazing" means blazing like its light. Having summoned all the Tathāgatas, one properly worships them through those called the Mother Goddesses, Gaurī and the others, and one should make the request with these words: "Let all the Tathāgatas empower me!" After that, they, having the colors and forms as described, empower one from golden vases with a stream of the nectar of bodhicitta, and one should visualize the crown ornament of Cittavajra. The four, Gaurī and the others, have as their crown ornaments Akṣobhya, the Eternal One, the Jewel, and Amitābha. The four in the intermediate directions, Pukkasī and the others, likewise have as their crown ornaments Akṣobhya, Vairocana, Ratnasambhava, and Amitābha; these are the purity of the aggregates, the elements, and the sense sources. After that, having blessed the vajra and the lotus, and having made offerings, praises, and the tasting of nectar, preceded by meditation on the six branches, one should practice meditation and recitation according to the rite at the three junctures of the day, in such a way that one's own mind does not grow weary.

This is the explanation of the fourth chapter from The Source of Mindfulness, the commentary on the difficult points of the Hevajra composed by the master Kṛṣṇa.

To teach that without realizing reality one will not abandon all the habitual tendencies of clinging, the words "Then, the chapter on reality" were spoken.

On "In reality there is no form": it is form because it is suited to be form; that is, it is matter. And there is no such thing, because when examined as one or many it is never established as an object, and also because matter is not observed as appearing. Therefore it is consciousness itself that appears distinctly in the aspects of blue, yellow, and so on. On "There is no seer either": since what is to be seen has no essential nature, the seeing consciousness does not exist as an apprehender either, for these two depend on each other. There is also no self or the like, because the passage that comes below, beginning "Form is apprehended by the eye," teaches that there is merely the nature of the outer and inner sense sources. The same application should be made to sound and the rest as well. Thus, through this

teaching that the outer and inner sense sources lack intrinsic nature, one should realize and comprehend that all entities, too, lack essential nature.

The passage beginning "Mother and" shows that there is no relationship of mother, daughter, and the like. For the blood and seminal fluid of the mother and the others are brought about and produced by karma; and if birth, abiding, aging and death, pleasure, and suffering rest on karma, then between whom, or by what, could a son and the others be said to be related to one another? That is simply not established. Therefore "mother" and the rest are the forms of Nairātmyā and the others, generated through mantra and mudrā, which are indivisible and empty of conceptions of the ordinary kind. By worshiping these very ones with the rite as it was taught, one becomes wholly intent on the unsurpassed primordial wisdom of the Tathāgatas.

To show that the castes, too, lack essential nature, the passage beginning "Dancer" was spoken. Birth into the castes of the dancer and the rest lacks essential nature, for no difference is seen in the color, shape, mind and mental factors, birth, aging, abiding, or impermanence of the castes of brahmins and the rest. Thus the yogin who sees the supreme reality distinguishes all these three realms merely by shape and the like, and not by divine family. "One should take girls endowed with beauty and youth": this is because they serve as a branch of the practice. It is not otherwise a matter of insisting on shape, color, and the like according to caste. Therefore, in order to perfect undefiled great bliss, one should give up the colors, shapes, and the like bound up with caste, and the various notions of "I" and "mine." Rather than holding back from some and treating others as not to be approached, one should touch the yoginīs without discrimination, as one's own body, and engage with them; and one should supremely honor and worship them with drink, food, clothing, ornaments, and fragrant and excellent things such as sandalwood and saffron.

"By the rite of wisdom and method": this is the rite of blessing the vajra and the lotus preceded by deity yoga, that is, through unsurpassed union. "Desiring reality" refers to worship through realizing the reality in which all phenomena are indivisible; that is, one should worship all the Tathāgatas. "With great effort" means not without respect. "The particulars should by no means be made known" means that one should not make it the domain of sentient beings who lack the fortune. The passage beginning "Demons, snakes, thieves, fire" means that if this is done before the eyes of people who lack the fortune, then in this life and the next, even emanations and the like will make him suffer.

The passage beginning "The seals of the five families" was taught as the cause for fully pacifying the mistaken conceptions habituated from one life to the next since beginningless time. "Vajra" is the Tathāgata who embodies the five kinds of primordial wisdom; the meaning is that it is with him that one seals. "It is always declared to be in six families" means: including the family of Vajrasattva. "There is no meditator" means that a meditator distinct from the mind, that is, a body, does not exist. "There is nothing to be meditated upon" means that one should understand that apart from that, there is also no intrinsic nature of anything to be meditated upon. On "There is no mantra, and no deity either": because there is no object apart from the mind, there is also no such thing as a mantra, being neither utterance nor what is uttered; and likewise there is no separate deity having the nature of faces, arms, and so on. If one objects, "In that case, when all phenomena are searched for, they turn out to be utterly empty in nature," it is said here, in the passage beginning "In the nature free from elaboration": "In the nature free from elaboration" refers to the nature of nonconceptual mind-only.

Deity and mantra abide in that mode; that is, one should understand that it is for the sake of training others that they are imputed to be deities and mantras and taught as such. Therefore, here, mantra and deity are to be understood as having the nature of the Dharma body, in which all phenomena are indivisible.

Although it is free from elaboration, it is taught through the distinction between what is to be accomplished and what accomplishes, in the passage beginning "Vairocana." He is Vairocana, the Illuminator, because he illuminates distinctly, in the mode in which there is neither grasped nor grasper. He is Akṣobhya, the Unshakable, because by nature he is wholly unmoving and undisturbed. He is Amogha, the Unfailing, because he bestows results on sentient beings without fail. He is Ratnasambhava, the Source of Jewels, because he possesses inconceivable qualities that are hard to find. rol means mutual dispute; because there is none, he is āroḷka. Because he beholds the world through reality, he is declared to be called "the self that contemplates reality." Likewise, to show what is denoted by the words "Brahmā" and the rest, the passage beginning "Brahmā, by turning back" was spoken.

Thus, for the great yogin who has understood that objects, relationships, castes, and outer mantras and deities lack essential nature, whatever has become an action of body, speech, or mind is all taught to be of the nature of

mantra, mudrā, and meditative concentration, in the passage beginning "Utterances are explained as recitation." "That is meditative concentration": whatever thought has the character of mind and mental factors, that is his meditative concentration.

If one wonders whether this is something shared with the hearers and the rest: it is not. In the passage beginning "From the father," "the father" is that whose nature is one's own mind alone. "As bliss" is bliss as such, which has the characteristic of benefiting all sentient beings. "Obtained" means attained from that. On "One should enjoy that bliss oneself": it is the nature of emptiness and compassion by its own nature, unsurpassed, without beginning or end; one is to awaken to it in full and perfect awakening. If one asks what that bliss is like, it is stated in the passage beginning "dying": the bliss by which one dies is that in which, as when one is parted from life, all these activities of body, speech, and mind have ceased, together with the life force, that is, the wind. That bliss is the nature of unsurpassed awakening. It is "meditative concentration" because it has become nonconceptual and one-pointed. "Is called" means that it is explained in conventional terms.

Alternatively, "the father" is the mind whose nature is wisdom-gnosis. "As" means perfect, just as it is. "Bliss" is the nature in which the three realms, together with joy, are of a single taste as great bliss. "One should enjoy that bliss oneself" means that one should come to know that unsurpassed great bliss, whose nature is suchness, through meditative concentration as well, without depending on an action seal (karmamudrā). "Dying" means that the aggregates, elements, and sense sources accompanied by defilements come to utter non-arising. "By which bliss" means by whatever nature of bliss has dawned. On "That bliss is meditative concentration": meditative concentration is the great bliss born from the very culmination, the nature of the great Vajradhara. These extend up to the words "taught and explained by the gurus as having the nature of one's own mind alone."

This is the explanation of the fifth chapter from The Source of Mindfulness, the commentary on the difficult points of the Hevajra composed by the master Kṛṣṇa.

Without realizing the conduct of the observance (vratacaryā), the unsurpassed primordial wisdom of omniscience will not be perfected; therefore the chapter on conduct was spoken, in the passage beginning "Then, furthermore." Conduct is the activities of body, speech, and mind that serve as the means

for attaining reality; it is supreme because it is highly praised. "Gone to its far shore" means gone there by reaching the culmination of what is nonconceptual and clear. "By which" means by whichever. "To the final goal" means to reality. "Proceeds" means has fully gone there. "The cause of the accomplishment of Hevajra" means what has become the cause of the accomplishment of the great seal (mahāmudrā); this is to be construed with "therefore one should fully engage in such conduct."

As to what that which is to be traveled is like, the passage beginning "By the meditator" was spoken; the meditator is the mind that has become powerful in meditation. "Should be worn" refers to whatever one wears, both to remove one's own faults by various means and to draw in the people to be trained. On "fine rings on the ears": they are rings because they are round all around; they are fine because they are well crafted and shining. This is also what is said below: "Akṣobhya in the form of the wheel." They are to be worn according to the oral instructions, distinguished as mirror-like primordial wisdom and the rest, and not otherwise.

On the passage beginning "A lone tree": if one asks, "Must a fixed place of meditation be adopted here, as taught in the Action Tantras and the others?", that is so: in order to look after yogins who aspire to a special meditation, these are to be regarded as places where the yoginīs gather. "A lone tree" is one blessed by yakṣas. A charnel ground is a place of corpses. "Of the Mother Goddesses" refers to goddesses, and their dwelling is the "house." At night, when people have fallen asleep, it is "solitary," that is, empty of people. "The outskirts" is where the voices of the villagers are not heard.

Alternatively, because it has branches such as the arms, the body itself is the lone tree. Since it is said,
"By this reasoning, which concerns the breath,
The body is called the charnel ground,"
the charnel ground, too, is that very body. The house of the Mother Goddesses is also that very body: the seven bodily constituents are the Mother Goddesses because they are the ground of birth, and it is the house because it holds them as a house does. It is solitary because desire and the like have fallen asleep; that is, it is free of conceptual thought. The center of the source of phenomena is the outskirts. The passage beginning "Some" means: once one has gained, through meditative concentration, whatever signs there are, such as warmth.

"If one wishes to engage in the conduct
In order to attain accomplishment":
the accomplishments are the common and the supreme accomplishments. Whoever has the wish for them should practice the awareness observance (vidyāvrata) together with the mudrā as described.

"It should be done with one of the family of one's own chosen deity":
the goddess endowed with the complexion and the characteristics taught in the tenth chapter of the tantra in two parts is "the family of one's own chosen deity," and it is with her. "Should be done" refers to "the seed of awakening is to be planted."

"Thoroughly trained" means: through the mantras, the tantras, the samayas and the secret signs.

The medicine is relied upon constantly, as a habit, according to the rite. As for "The medicine should be eaten": the medicine is what is known as "scent." The water is the substance urine; and the blood, the semen and the flesh that are present among them should also be taken. "One will not be harmed by old age and death" means: through relying on it constantly, as a habit, according to the rite. "Always protected" means that through this rite one will always be protected from hostile adversaries. The rest is easy to understand.

"Desire" means training in the conduct in order to obtain gain and honor from others. "Delusion" means grasping at benefit, harm and the like in terms of "I" and "mine." "Fear" refers to the particular obstructions that others create in order to hinder the result for those who have entered upon the conduct. "Anger" is the mind's inner turmoil from being bent on striking others, or even oneself, with a stick or the like. "Shame" means losing heart in oneself in view of the conduct of others. "Sleep" is given as an example: excitement, regret, torpor, and so on up to doubt, are to be abandoned.

"One should practice the conduct without doubt" means: through having wholly given oneself up. "By giving away the body as a gift" means: in order to nurture all sentient beings, one should wholly offer and give oneself to the guru, the heroes and the yoginīs, and only after that begin the conduct.

"Having examined part and non-part" means: when one examines them, the giver, the recipient and the gift, being free of oneness and manyness, cannot be apprehended. "Then no gift should be given" shows that very point: it means that one should not hold the perception of giving and the like.

In the passage beginning "Food": food is cooked grain and the like. The meaning is that one should partake of these without concern for savoring their taste, and should abandon grasping at them as tasty or not tasty. "Conceiving of the desirable and the undesirable" means: accepting and rejecting are in their essential nature conceptual thought, which makes the great mass of suffering grow. The rest is readily understood.

In the passage beginning "Training and," training is characterized by engaging in virtue and turning away from nonvirtue. "Rite" means entering the maṇḍala and the like. "Shame" means not doing what accords with oneself. "Through the intrinsic nature of all things" means: in the manner of great bliss, in which all phenomena are nondual. "Should roam" means: in the various modes of deportment. "Yogin" means one who knows how to apply the observance of the earrings and the like. "O Great Loving One" is an address to Vajragarbha.

The passage beginning "Fire offerings, sacrifices" means that, having abandoned the elaborations of fire offerings and the like for this purpose, and being freed from mistaken conceptual thought, one is to accomplish unsurpassed awakening by being fully endowed with the conduct of the observance of reality. "Wholly endowed with union" means: once the mind has become stable. Alternatively, the passage beginning "Fire offerings, sacrifices" was spoken with regard to those yogins who think that they are purified merely by acts such as fire offerings. It means that, apart from the conduct of unsurpassed reality, conceptions such as outer and inner fire offerings will not lead to the great accomplishment. Since it is said further on, "There is nothing at all that is not to be done," one is wholly freed from samaya and vow.

"Equal to Śakra (Indra)" means: if one sees before one any seizing spirit (graha) whatsoever endowed with the form, strength, diligence and might of Śakra, one should not be afraid of it, and should not fall away from one's own samādhi. "Of him" means: if one should not be afraid even of him, what need is there to speak of other pretas? If one asks, "How then should one act?", the answer is the passage beginning "In the manner of a lion." The lion is the Blessed One, because he is not overwhelmed by the wild beasts of the afflictions. "His manner" means being like him; it is said so that one may realize one's own samādhi in every circumstance.

In the passage beginning "Always," "always" means without interruption. It is the drink of compassion because, having perfected enjoyment and emanation, and in accordance with those to be trained, one emanates in many different

forms in many different world systems and engages in teaching the Dharma, which, preceded by the removal of all the faults of sentient beings, becomes the means of attaining the primordial wisdom of the Tathāgata. That is why it says, "For the sake of all sentient beings."

As for "the drink of union," union is the primordial wisdom in which method and wisdom are nondual. That itself is the drink of yogins, and the intoxication is by the dharmakāya, whose characteristic is the indivisibility of phenomena. What is intoxicated is all phenomena. "One is not intoxicated by any other drink" means that, apart from the nectar drink of emptiness and compassion, nothing else brings intoxication with the dharmakāya, the very nature of all phenomena. This too has been said:

Those who wish to manifest the form body, complete with the major and minor marks,
Attain it not by meditative concentration alone, but by being endowed with diligence.
All the qualities of a buddha, the unshared ones and the rest, without effort:
Those who wish for direct realization of the dharmakāya will come to rely on completion.

Alternatively, "the drink of compassion" means this: in order to care for sentient beings who delight in drinking liquor, one endowed with compassion should always demonstrate pure conduct; and taking it up completely, like a poison purified by mantra, one should partake of it untainted by the afflictions, and satisfy all the Tathāgatas, who are the purified aggregates and the rest, with the samādhi of nectar.

"For the sake of sentient beings" means that whatever activity of body, speech and mind the yogins have, all of it is undertaken so that beings may delight in this supreme vehicle.

As for "delighting in the drink of union," union is by way of the samādhi in which method and wisdom are indivisible. Its drink is to be kept in mind always, without interruption. "The yogin" means one skilled in all the rites of samaya and samādhi. "No other drink" means that one should not resort to any other drink, because one's own samaya would then be damaged, and in order to guard against people losing faith. "Intoxicated" means that, preceded by an alteration of body and speech, one becomes triumphant. This too has been said:

In order to give rise to pride,
One should grow accustomed to a little of this,
In such a way that one does not become drunk,
And do it with a mind of supreme joy.

This is the explanation of the sixth chapter, from The Source of Mindfulness, a commentary on the difficult points of Hevajra composed by the master Kṛṣṇa.

To show that without understanding the signs, which are not the domain of those who have good fortune, one will not recognize one's own samaya-holders, the chapter called "Signs" is then taught. "Signs" are the conventions of body and speech used by the yoginīs.

In the passage beginning "The outer gathering": at those places of gathering, so that the yoginīs, out of supreme compassion, may take the practitioner into their care in their nature as the dharmakāya, the saṃbhogakāya and the nirmāṇakāya, endowed with the moods such as the erotic, one should, with a mind of supreme joy, provide in abundance whatever food, drink, bedding and the like are asked for. Then, when one has respectfully bowed one's head to those samaya-holders of one's own, they, according to one's fortune and preceded by teaching the Dharma, also bestow the accomplishments such as the eye ointment and the foot ointment. And the yoginīs of all the lands, the field-born, the mantra-born and those whose nature is innate, to whom one bows one's head with respect, are intent on bestowing the transcendent accomplishment. So that the practitioner who has made merit may truly see them, they have been gathered together and taught here.

In the passage beginning "The sacred site and the secondary sacred site," "In these there are twelve kinds" refers to the ground of engagement through aspiration, the Joyous, the Stainless, the Luminous, the Radiant, the Very Difficult to Overcome, the Manifest, the Gone Far, the Immovable, Excellent Intelligence, the Cloud of Dharma, and Universal Light. These very ones are the grounds of the lineage and the rest, distinguished according to the dispositions of sentient beings. The designations of the sacred sites as Jālandhara and the rest are those of the buddhas and vajra holders; in accordance with those to be trained, they are also the gathering places of those named Nairātmyā and the others, and they bring about the attainment of the result, the ground of Vajradhara. The passage beginning "The lord of the ten grounds" shows Vajrasattva, of whom these very grounds, from the Joyous up to their culmination in the Cloud of Dharma, have become the cause. As for

"otherwise in this," it means that there is no distinction at all. "Sun" means a day. "For the sake of all sentient beings" means: so that all sentient beings may attain the mundane and transcendent accomplishments. "The yoginīs" are the field-born, the mantra-born, and those whose nature is innate. "Gather" means that they are assuredly assembled there.

"Banner" means one who has been hanged. "Struck by a weapon" means one killed by another. "Seven-times returned" means one who has circled among human beings for seven births; this is for the sake of attaining the accomplishments described below.

If one asks, "Well then, if such a one has not died of his own accord, is the rite of severing the union, described below, not to be performed?", it is not so. In the passage beginning "With compassion": it is resorted to out of compassion for those who invariably abide in the causes of suffering and cannot be tamed by any other, in order to pacify their great suffering. "With effort" means: through the rites of mantra and the like. "The skilled one" means: through knowing the application. That is why it says, "One lacking in compassion will not succeed": all accomplishments have compassion as their root, and so those who have abandoned it will not come to accomplishment. To make that very point clear, the passage beginning "Therefore" is stated. The meaning is that one should strive to generate compassion intensely, in order to bring all mundane and transcendent aims to perfection.

If one says, "In that case, no one should ever perform the rite of severing the union described below," that is not so. As for "In order to tame all the wicked": the wicked are those who harm the Three Jewels and those who harm the guru and the sentient beings who keep samaya, and it is in order to lead them in. Moreover, having shown them honor and encouraged them with gifts and the like, one should inspire faith in them by giving the one-day vows and the rest described below, and lead them in according to their capacity as vessels of the three vehicles. If even by that one cannot lead them in, then, by means of what is described below, one should perform, according to the rite, the act characterized as the separation that severs the union.

This is also stated in The Manifest Awakening of Vairocana: "Here a bodhisattva should turn back from taking life as far as possible; otherwise, sentient beings who harm the Three Jewels," and so on, as it is set out there at length.

If someone says, "In that case, everything is to be done by this rite of swift means," that is not so. On "Principally, one should strictly forbid it," the meaning is: one should forbid it in every case whose cause is not the wicked.

In the passage beginning "In this regard one should understand it thus," day and night are declared to be the purity of method and wisdom.

In the passage beginning "There is nothing that should not be done," the meaning is that there is nothing at all, taking life and the like included, that is not to be done. "Not to be eaten" refers to the things that worldly people condemn. "Here there is nothing that is not to be thought" refers to covetousness and the like. "Nothing not to be said, good or evil" refers to lying and the like, on the part of the yogins of glorious Heruka who are engaged in the welfare of others. As it is also said:

For one endowed with compassion there is no nonvirtue;
Even the things forbidden are permitted to him.

"As I am, so are sentient beings" means that here, between oneself and others, there is no difference whatsoever in pleasure and pain, or in semen, blood and the like. "As is my own self, so are others" means that these are mere aggregates imagined through error; one should understand that all things called "self" and "other" are empty. Therefore all phenomena are sameness itself, and for one who has taken on the way of glorious Heruka, wishing to liberate the entire realm of sentient beings without exception, everything, just as it has been taught, is entirely free of fault.

"Thus one contemplates all as the self of union" means that one contemplates the very self of all beings as having the nature of the stainless meditative absorption of method and wisdom.

In the passage beginning "Oneself, food and drink," the meaning is that whatever one eats, one should make all of it into the ten nectars, and one should make what one drinks into the awakening mind (bodhicitta). Having abandoned conceptions of what is eaten, the eating, and the eater, one makes the mantras and deities nondual; free of conceptions of the object of offering, the offerer, and the offering, one should meditate on oneself as the very embodiment emanated in a special way by the compassion of all the Tathāgatas, and then begin the offering.

In the passage beginning "Whatever," whatever action is of a bodily kind and whatever has the nature of speech, all of that is mantra and mudrā. If one asks

where, it is "when one abides in the state of glorious Heruka." The meaning of Heruka is taught in the passage beginning "śrī is nondual."

In the passage beginning "Whatever people," piśitaṃ means flesh. "By the wise one" means by one skilled in yoga. All those sentient beings, through the inconceivable yoga of mantra and deity, are born as gods and humans, remember their former lives, and, endowed with happiness, come under the yogin's power.

On "By the yoga of vajra and skull": "vajra" is bhrūṃ āṃ jrīṃ khaṃ hūṃ, the seeds of the five Tathāgatas, which embody the five wisdoms. "Skull" is the lotus vessel that is the transformation of the syllable ā. As for "yoga": below, upon wind, on a maṇḍala of fire, in the lotus vessel, are the seeds of the Tathāgatas. Above it, in the space at a distance of one span, the syllable oṃ, standing on the moon of a khaṭvāṅga, draws in the nectar of wisdom, which is made one with the nectar of samaya. Then, through the yoga of the three syllables enclosed between two hoḥ syllables, one should eat, in such a way that the torma comes first.

This is the explanation of the seventh chapter, from The Source of Mindfulness, a commentary on the difficult points of the Hevajra composed by the master Kṛṣṇa.

After the chapter on signs, with the wish to explain the circle of yoginīs, the passage beginning "Then" was spoken. "Anthers" means the transformation of the anthers, that is, the round inner tier. "Triangle" means the transformation of the source of phenomena (dharmodaya), that is, the outer square maṇḍala. These are the general characteristics of a maṇḍala, and they belong to the drawn maṇḍala of Picuvajra, of which it is said, "One family, with four doors."

"āli kāli" means that the vowels and consonants are precisely the moon and sun, the purity of the mirror-like wisdom and of the wisdom of equality. "Seed and emblem" and so forth means: at the center of these. "Of Vajrasattva" means of the Vajrasattva who has become the cause. "Seat" means the place of generation; the sense is "through the sequence of the five manifest awakenings."

On "In the mass arisen from syllables": "mass" means the body. It arises from syllables, but Vajrasattva does not come from any form at all. In the passage beginning "One should not wish for hūṃ, phaṭ and the like," the words "and the like" refer to the blessing by the five families. One should not wish for the blessing of vajra and lotus and the rest, because that is the rite for binding the

bodhicitta. The passage beginning "The form of the mind" is easy to understand. In "Emblems, faces and so on, like a son," the words "and so on" indicate that the others too, such as the feet, should be included.

"Having the form of the moon, with the light of a jewel" means that the body is white in color. "Or else, having the nature of the moon" refers to conventional bodhicitta, because it is like the kunda jasmine. "Jewel" means what has entered within the jewel. "Light" means brilliant radiance: the defining character of great bliss, completely free of all conceptual elaboration, in which all phenomena are indivisible. For that very reason, since its own mudrās, faces, shape and the like are not established, it is said to be "like a son." The meaning is this: in order to take on the enjoyment body, the Vajra Bearer whose nature is the indivisibility of all phenomena, this very Blessed One is duly roused by the songs of the four goddesses described below, and from him the three bodies arise in sequence.

"Gaurī and the rest arise from this" means from the Vajrasattva who has become the cause. All of these, too, will be shown clearly in the chapter on the manifestation of Heruka.

On "Distinct from the others by syllable": "syllable" means the seed. It is by seed and sign that they are distinct from the others, that is, by being distinguished from one another; it is not by cause.

"Greatly fierce" means endowed with the dance of the fierce sentiment. Some say that the passage beginning "First one should meditate on it as black" teaches, in their order, the body colors of the six yoginīs of the eye and so on. Others say that the circle is to be meditated upon as differentiated by the six classes of beings. "Six limbs" means having the nature of the six colors.

On "Likewise again at the end of the joy of cessation": the middle between supreme joy (paramānanda) and the joy of cessation (viramānanda) is the "end," that is, reality. "Again" marks a distinction. "Likewise" means by that which possesses the six limbs. As it has also been said:

The whole circle of deities is of a single color;
one should meditate on it as having the nature of great bliss.

Or else, in "the end of the joy of cessation," "end" means once it has come to be. "Again" means afterward. "Likewise" means that, just as with the wisdom-gnosis (prajñājñāna), so one should meditate after that; this will be shown below by a verse.

For the sake of the practice of the completion stage, the passage beginning "The expanse of space" was spoken. Someone may say, "Then reversing ordinary appearance through the generation stage does not become the great accomplishment by way of the total purity of the deities." That is true. For those who are unable to meditate on emptiness free from all elaboration, the unsurpassed great bliss whose nature is method and wisdom, the divisions of the purity of the aggregates and so on, and the divisions of the generation stage in condensed, intermediate and extensive forms, have been taught. As it is said:

Those of fine intellect should first meditate on the generation stage, and do so constantly;
mantra and mudrā, the pure ornaments and the armor, all these one surely should not proclaim.
Afterward, endowed with clarity, continuously, even for a single instant, with that very one-pointed mind,
one should ever contemplate together the meditation of the completion stage, great bliss, destroyer of existence.

Thus it should be understood that it is by the very meditation of the completion stage that all the accomplishments of the supreme yogins are swiftly perfected.

Some explain that the generation stage and the completion stage are to be made indivisible. They say this is because it was said, "Without a body, how could there be bliss?" and so on.

To teach the four divisions of the innate (sahaja), the passage beginning "Joy" was spoken. When ordinary conceptuality has been reversed, the Blessed One Vajrasattva, who has genuinely arisen from the meditative absorption of the five kinds of wisdom, is joy (ānanda). "Supreme joy is the yoginī": since supreme joy arises through union with the yoginī, she too is called by that name. "The joy of passion, without remainder" means that, preceded by the entry of all the Tathāgatas without remainder, it arises in the form of the melted bodhicitta and becomes all the deities of the maṇḍala; this is purity. "Through the means of that bliss, all-knowing" means that, through the means of the wisdom-gnosis, that bliss knows all. That very bliss is the Blessed One, the great Vajradhara, who has become the result; and because its nature is constant realization, it is also the innate joy.

In the passage beginning "Supreme joy is existence": because supreme joy has the nature of passion, existence comes from supreme joy. That is, having embarked on desirable and undesirable actions accompanied by passion, one comes into existence in the happy and unhappy destinies. On "Nirvāṇa is purity": the defining characteristic of purity is the gnosis free of passion in which all the faculties are expanded; it is becoming free of attachment to the existences whose nature is attachment. For once one is free of passion toward the desire, form and formless realms, actions need not even be deliberately abandoned. Thus, since there is no thought of karma and the afflictions, the mere cessation of the aggregates and so on is called nirvāṇa. "The middle is mere joy" means that joy too, being mere pleasure, is passion itself. On "The innate has abandoned these": to have abandoned joy, supreme joy and the joy of cessation means to be free of them.

That is so; yet, to teach the nature of the innate, the passage beginning "The innate is not taught by another" was spoken. The guru and others are not able to teach the reality of the innate, because it is not the object of any verbal conception. If one asks, "Then how is it to be known?", it is said, in the passage beginning "It is known by oneself, from merit": from one's own merit it is imparted through the succession of gurus, and there one is to know the oral instruction on the reversal of the mantra's action, that is, one is to experience it for oneself. Or else, "It is known by oneself, from merit" refers to finding a consort (mudrā), which is said to come from the good deeds of one's own mind-stream. In that case, "attending upon the succession of gurus" means this: having slightly stirred, with finger and tongue, the channel called the Evil-Stirrer, which is found from the guru's instructions through becoming familiar with it, one's own vajra, in accordance with the rite, becomes directed toward it, and for those endowed with great merit, great bliss will certainly be produced.

"Since all beings arise from me" shows here that they do not come from some other cause, are not causeless, are not pervaded by another, are not of some other nature, and are not without a nature.

The passage beginning "Thus" means that, having fully understood the completion stage as it has been taught, one should become familiar with it, that is, meditate on it, and through what accords with it one should set mind and body at ease. "Well composed" means possessing sharp faculties. "Will be accomplished" means that, as it has been taught, in this very life the nature of bliss will be completely perfected.

If one asks, "By what sort of person?", it is "Even by a man of little merit," that is, even by one whose power of merit is slight. If one asks, "By doing what?", it is by meditating at all times on the reality of all phenomena as self-awareness. This will also be shown clearly by the passage beginning "The former bliss."

In the passage beginning "Stable and," whatever phenomena there are, stable or moving, one meditates on as having the nature of great bliss, indivisible from one's own mind-stream. As it is also said: "By that very means, called 'together with one's own form,' one should contemplate oneself as having the nature of the deity's bliss."

Someone may object: "If that is so, then grass and the like would not of themselves be self-aware of the nature of unsurpassed great bliss, because they are material forms without mind." Therefore it is said, "In their oneness there is no other," which is easy to understand.

In the passage beginning "Accomplishment comes from self-awareness," one may think: "If the accomplishment described comes about through that very meditation on the completion stage called self-awareness, then why is someone taught whose nature is described in these lines and the rest:

Not too tall and not too short,
not too dark, and not fair either?"

That is true. To those who are of inferior faculties, who take pleasure in afflictions such as passion, and who are unable to meditate on the great seal (mahāmudrā) endowed with the supreme of all aspects, this action seal (karmamudrā) is taught: one who knows the samayas and vows taught in the tantra, as she may be found. To others, the wisdom seal (jñānamudrā) called the great seal is taught. It is also said:

Through familiarity with the wisdom seal,
the woman endowed with awakening is given up;
from that very perfected gnosis
the great seal will be accomplished.

"Actions are by nature self-aware" means: whatever there may be, actions of body, speech and mind, or even afflictions, all of them are nothing but self-awareness. "From harmful actions comes birth" means: for others, through their hearing and recollection, and through seeing, hearing and touching, harm comes to sentient beings; and from falling away from their own meditative absorption, by that cause there is birth in one existence after

another, which is to say, many lifetimes.

"He himself is the maker" means that he emanates all the buddhas from himself. "He himself gathers in" means that all the Tathāgatas are fully gathered together into the nature of great bliss. "He himself is king" is said because he teaches the Dharma to those to be trained, to each as befits them. "He himself is lord" is said because he has the power to join the minds of all the fortunate to virtue.

"Passion and aversion" refers to the afflictions such as passion; it means by the factors that have come to be discordant with them. "There" means the nature of the dharma body (dharmakāya), in which there is nothing discordant. "Abides" means enjoying, as the embodiment of stainless gnosis. "Delightful" means the emanation body.

"Even a sixteenth part" means that it cannot be rivaled even in the smallest fraction, just as the light of a firefly cannot rival even a fraction of the light of the sun freed from its covering veil of clouds.

In the passage beginning "From the source of phenomena," whatever is born from the source of phenomena is called by that name. "Gnosis" means having the nature of the gnosis that is individually self-aware. "Equal to space" is said because it has no object of focus. "Together with method" is said because it is the body accomplished from the heart. "The three worlds are born from it" means that they genuinely arise from it, bearing the characteristics of the world. "Having the nature of wisdom and method" means in the form of woman and man.

In the passage beginning "The form of semen," semen itself is the form, and that very form is the Blessed One. "Its bliss is declared to be the beloved" means that the nature of the bodhicitta, held in special restraint, is the beloved (kāminī), that is, wisdom. At the time of that bliss, whatever has taken form is all the Blessed One, that is, method; and because it is indivisible from bliss, it is also semen.

"This, free of one and many" means that, because these forms appear as distinct particulars, they are free of one and many, and so they are emptiness.

On "A single instant is supreme joy": "a single instant" is the defining character of the forms, and "supreme joy" means becoming the nature of nondual great bliss.

On "self-aware": these are luminous by their own nature, since it is their nature always to have arisen in this way. "Gnosis" means that it is not inert matter; it is the very nature of nonconceptuality. "Beyond the path of speech" is said because it is not the domain of names, signs, or any verbal conceptuality. "The stage of self-blessing" means that the purities of mantra and the rest abide in the mind by their own nature.

On "Having the nature of that omniscient gnosis": omniscient gnosis is without attachment and without obstruction toward all things, and these too have its nature.

In the passage beginning "Earth and," "in an instant" means in the instant of manifest awakening. "It is not harmed by earth and the rest" means that gnosis arises neither as an object bearing its own aspect nor as a subject bearing the aspect of another. If one asks how that is to be understood, the passage beginning "Heaven, the human realm" was spoken to teach its nature: in that supreme instant, the three worlds too are perfected in a single form. In the passage beginning "The distinction of self and other," there, conceptions of self and other simply cannot harm it.

"All the Vedas and tenets" means: also from the conclusions that others have arrived at. "The host of actions" means also the conclusions that others have established; it is the application of the host of actions and so on. "It is not accomplished by them" means that it is not accomplished by them as the embodiment of the great seal. "Existence becomes pure" means that through them only the production of purity is properly brought about.

The passage beginning "Without realizing that" means that without realizing the gnosis taught earlier, there is no accomplishment whose nature is method and wisdom, neither in this birth nor in others.

That is why the passage beginning "Whoever does not know Hevajra" was spoken. Hevajra is the embodiment of the profound and the vast, through which all the qualities of accomplishment are swiftly perfected. "Does not know" means does not know it even through mere conviction. The meaning is that the toil of those who strive through other tantras for the accomplishment of the great seal is fruitless.

In order to bring this too to completion, what is called "the Fierce One (Caṇḍālī) blazing at the navel," the passage beginning "The river flowing continuously, and" was spoken. "The river flowing continuously" refers to the indestructible one in the form of haṃ, always facing downward; from the

juncture a stream of nectar trickles down. "The lamp burning continuously" means that one contemplates her who has the form of aṃ, blazing without interruption, wisdom luminous by nature, as facing upward. These teach the distinctive features of what has the nature of mantra. "Always that very" means through the meditation on the form body as it has been taught. "One should abide" means by not letting the mind dwell elsewhere for even a single instant.

This is the explanation of the eighth chapter, from The Source of Mindfulness, a commentary on the difficult points of the Hevajra composed by the master Kṛṣṇa.

To show that without realizing purity one does not attain omniscience merely by meditating on the circle of deities, the passage beginning "Then, another" was spoken. Purity is twofold, divided into the purity of reality and the purity of the deities. First the purity of reality is stated, in the passage beginning "All things." The purity of all pure things, outer and inner, is suchness. Just as the suchness of the noble ones is, so too is that of those who are not noble: through this stainlessness by nature, it is always of an unconditioned nature, like space, which abides forever. "Is said" means that those who are to cultivate it in that manner everywhere should realize and comprehend this undifferentiated purity as suchness.

In the passage beginning "Afterward," "each one" refers to the purity of the deities by the division into the aggregates and so on; it is to be understood from the passage beginning "The form aggregate is Vajrā."

If one asks, "Why then are the faculties and so on said to be purified?", here it is said, in the passage beginning "Of unknowing and the afflictions": unknowing is ignorance, the grasping at a self and at what belongs to a self. The particular states of mind that become the cause of desirable and undesirable actions are the afflictions. "Covering veil" means being covered over by these, and the point is to purify them. That very thing is stated in the passage beginning "Purity whose nature is self-awareness": once the stains of ignorance have been cleared away by the very gnosis of self-awareness, it is the very nature of the purity of all phenomena, because all the phenomena meditated upon are also pure by nature.

In the passage beginning "The objects," because form and the rest are pure by nature, what is called self-awareness is "supreme," that is, it is bliss of a special kind. In the passage beginning "Moreover," the meaning is that,

moreover, whatever forms and so on have appeared from the yogin's mind-stream are pure, because the things of the world have the nature of awakening.

In the passage beginning "O Blessed One," to the thought, "How many are those whose purity has just been stated?", it is said here, "Form and so on." If one asks why, it is the passage beginning "Because they become the grasped and the grasper." Its meaning is that, within what is by nature indivisible and nondual, they appear separately through the division into form and the rest, and so they are impure. Therefore, in order to state, for each of them, its purity as a deity, the passage beginning "The form aggregate is Vajrā" is set forth. That is to say, accomplishment is attained by the yogin who embodies the reality of the purity of these, Vajrā and the rest.

With the passage beginning "Pukkasī in Īśāna (the northeast)," the division of the directions, which these chapters on the circle of yoginīs did not teach, is taught here. These show that, to reverse ordinary pride, one should take on the pride of the deity; and that when, ordinary pride having first been abandoned through the forms of the deities properly generated from that purity, one focuses on all phenomena as of one taste, the dharma body whose nature is great bliss will be fully perfected. As it is said:

To abandon one's former pride,
one should take on oneself the pride of the deity.
To abandon that pride as well,
one should meditate without an object of focus.
To abandon each earlier one,
one should take on pride from the former to the latter.
When the mind is placed in equipoise,
then that is declared to be "reality."

Thus it is fashioned by this form of mantra and deity, and the meaning is that this too is to be brought into the reality of the ultimate mantra. This is also stated below: "One should make elaboration free of elaboration." Its meaning is this: "elaboration" is the aggregates and so on, purified in the manner of the deities' forms; "free of elaboration" is emptiness, and one should fully understand it as having the nature of the unsurpassed great bliss of method and wisdom.

For that very reason the purity of the Blessed One's arms and so on, described below, is stated in the passage beginning "The arms are the purity of the

emptinesses." Just as the water element, gold and space are pure, so these too, once the mere appearance imputed by conceptual thought has ceased, are pure by nature and are the embodiment of self-aware great bliss, free of all the stains of conceptual thought. It is through this very purity that one becomes free of all clinging; it is not a purity achieved by mere imputation.

In the passage beginning "The arms," "the emptinesses" are these: the emptiness of the inner, the emptiness of the outer, the emptiness of the outer and inner, the emptiness of emptiness, the great emptiness, the emptiness of the ultimate, the emptiness of the conditioned, the emptiness of the unconditioned, the emptiness of what transcends the extremes, the emptiness of what has neither beginning nor end, the emptiness of what is not to be discarded, the emptiness of intrinsic nature, the emptiness of all phenomena, the emptiness of own characteristics, the emptiness of non-apprehension, and the emptiness of the nonexistence of things. The purity of these emptinesses is the sixteen arms.

"The feet" means the feet, with a second pair added. "The purity of the māras" refers to the māra of the divine son, the māra of the afflictions, the māra of the aggregates, and the māra of the Lord of Death. Of these, the māra of the divine son is characterized by torpor and sleep, and by regret and doubt. The māra of the afflictions is passion and the rest. The māra of the aggregates is sickness, old age and so on. The māra of the Lord of Death is the cessation of life and of the faculties. These, transformed into purity, are the four feet.

On "The faces are the eight liberations": "Having form, one sees forms" is the first liberation. "Perceiving no form within, one sees forms outside" is the second liberation. "Having directly realized with the body the liberation of the beautiful, and having perfected it, one abides in it" is the third liberation. The sphere of infinite space is the fourth. The sphere of infinite consciousness is the fifth. The sphere of nothingness is the sixth. The sphere of neither perception nor nonperception is the seventh. The meditative attainment of cessation is the eighth. Thus the purity of the eight liberations is the eight faces.

"The three vajras" are Khecarī (the Sky-Goer), Bhūcarī (the Earth-Goer) and Nairātmyā. "By these" means by those just explained: one should understand that the aggregates and the rest are purified, each in its order.

The unsurpassed purity is stated in the passage beginning "By whatever things." "By whatever" means that people are bound again and again by

karma and afflictions, which have the nature of the aggregates, elements and sense sources. "By those very things" refers to the aggregates and so on, purified as having the nature of deities; through that, one is freed from the bonds of existence. The meaning is that whoever does not know the illusory nature of all things, which are like the horses, elephants and cities conjured by a magician, is bound by form and the rest, and by those very things one is set free.

"Delusion" is not knowing reality. One whose heart is entangled in all suffering will not find what is called accomplishment, the embodiment of the great seal. For that very reason the passage beginning "Therefore" was spoken. Its meaning is this: when those who have realized the reality of things such as bells, which appear separately, as distinct from their own minds, look upon all beings as having the nature of suchness, not distinct from the purified mind, then finding unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening is not difficult.

This is the explanation of the ninth chapter, from The Source of Mindfulness, a commentary on the difficult points of the Hevajra composed by the master Kṛṣṇa.

Without understanding the maṇḍala one should not confer empowerment, and without understanding empowerment one should not teach reality. Therefore the empowerment preceded by the maṇḍala is taught in the passage beginning "Then." "Embodying the deity" means embodying the two-armed Heruka. The characteristics of the ground on which the maṇḍala is drawn are stated in the passage beginning "A garden, and."

In the passage beginning "There, the knowledge consort (vidyā)," the point is this: earlier the types of consort were taught for the sake of the conduct; now the types of consort for completing the empowerment are taught. The passage beginning "Five families" shows that here, within the maṇḍala of the assembly of the pure ones, Gaurī and the rest, the empowerment is to be conferred together with many consorts born of the lotus family and the others. Therefore it is held that at the very outset their faces should be covered, in order to gladden and calm the mind, since its arousal is accompanied by weak faith and a lack of enthusiasm.

The wisdom-gnosis is taught in the passage beginning "Arisen from self-awareness"; it is the end of supreme joy. "Gnosis" means that its nature is fully luminous of itself. "Free of the awareness of self and other" means that no awareness, such as grasping at self and other, remains in it. It is "equal to

space" because it is unobstructed. It is "free of dust" because it is free of faults. It is "empty" because no imagined aspect is apprehended in it.

On "From the nature of existence and nonexistence": because it has the nature of self-awareness, it is existence; because it is free of all conceptions, it is nonexistence. It is "supreme" because it is unsurpassed. Through its nature of emptiness and compassion, "method and wisdom are commingled." Because it is the end of supreme joy and the very beginning of the joy of cessation, "passion and freedom from passion are commingled." "That very" refers to it, whose character is the wisdom that has quelled all elaboration. Because it is the element of the Tathāgatas, it is "the life of living beings." "That very" means precisely what has just been taught. "Supreme" is said because it is nonconceptual. It is "unchanging" because, in the manner of suchness, it does not move in any respect. "Omniscient" is said because that very thing, as nothing but one's own mind, reaches into everything. "It abides in all bodies" is said because, in the manner of mind, it abides preeminently in all embodied beings. "Existence and nonexistence arise from it" means that the conceptions of existence and nonexistence arise from the very nature of great bliss, in which all phenomena are indivisible. "Of others" means of other people, that is, of other disputants. "Whatever" means whatever designations there are, such as self, spirit (puruṣa) and person: all of these too arise from that very thing.

"The intrinsic nature of all things": because it has the nature of the expanse of phenomena (dharmadhātu), that very thing is the intrinsic nature of all things. It is also said:

Since apart from the expanse of phenomena
no phenomenon exists.

"It abides in illusory form" is said because it is characterized as taking on the form of whatever it is imagined to be. "Thus" refers to the manner of the swift means to bliss just explained. As for "Vajragarbha and the others," vajra is the five gnoses, and garbha is their essence; "and the others" is said of those who are foremost. "Tathāgatas" is said of those who realize the suchness of all sentient beings, which is unchanging and unerring.

As for "having attained supreme wonder," "supreme" is the nature of unsurpassed great bliss. The realization that was sought for many eons in other tantras without being understood: that is the wonder. "Having fully attained it, they fainted" means that they were overcome by a swoon, thinking, "There is nothing else more excellent than this." "They fell to the

ground" means that through compassion they reached the ground beyond the world and, having become the domain of the fortunate, they fell. "Hevajra" is the one whose nature is unsurpassed compassion and wisdom. He is called "the single body of all buddhas." "All buddhas" are those said to be equal to space. "Body" means the body of these buddhas, and in it he alone is the one.

Teaching that he has the nature of the innate, it says, "Not desire," and so on. "Desire" is supreme joy. "Freedom from desire" is the joy of cessation. "The nature of the middle" is what is free from both desire and freedom from desire and so lies in the middle; it is merely joy. "The three" are these, desire and the rest. "Abandoning" means being free from adopting and rejecting; this is the innate. "Perfect awakening" is said because its very nature is to be awakened by itself. "Is called" shows that this is taught merely conventionally. So that beginners may understand it, the text says, "Before the joy of cessation," and so on.

For yogins intent on constant meditation, the signs of accomplishment are stated in the passage beginning "First, it is like a cloud." When the habitual tendencies of the darkness of ignorance have been removed, the body appears as if veiled and covered by clouds: this is the first sign. "Accomplished" means that after that something is accomplished: the body perfected earlier appears and is seen as if it were an emanation. This is the second. As for "after that," thereafter, once the darkness of ignorance has been completely destroyed, now and then, for about the space of a finger snap, it remains perfectly clear, like a dream. This is the third. As for "sleeping and waking," with no distinction between the states of dreaming and waking, the appearance of gnosis is perfectly clear, and a body that is constantly clear arises. This is the fourth. When in this way the accomplishment arises whose defining characteristic is the indivisibility of the nature of all phenomena, then the defining characteristics of the Great Seal (mahāmudrā) are complete.

To teach that the maṇḍala should be drawn in order to perfect the common and supreme accomplishments, and also in order to benefit all sentient beings, it says, "The Teacher proclaimed the wheel," and so on. "In the east" and so on means that the wheel consists of these very ones that were taught in the maṇḍala of Nairātmyā. "Then" means after the empowerment has been completed. "Reality" means the unerring. "Truly explained" means that the true collection is to be taught. Because that very reality is free from the stains of the afflictions, it is "pure." Because it is an awareness whose nature is discernment, it is "of the very nature of gnosis."

As for "saṃsāra and nirvāṇa," that which has the nature of the aggregates, elements, and sense sources accumulated by a mind that imagines wrongly, and which is characterized by grasped object and grasping subject, on which rest the conceptions of self and mine, of pleasure and pain, and so on, is saṃsāra. That very thing, being completely freed from all conceptual elaboration, is luminous by nature, and this is the nature of nirvāṇa; for these various distinctions are emanated by mind alone. As it is also said:

Between existence and nirvāṇa
there is not the slightest difference;
the thorough understanding of existence
is what is called nirvāṇa.

This very point is also stated in the passage beginning "supreme joy." "Supreme" is reality, and that very reality is utterly joyful. "Entity" refers to what has the nature of the supported, and that does not exist. "Non-entity" refers to what serves as the support, namely the celestial palace. "Body" refers to the deities who are the five aggregates in their purity. "Grasped object" refers to Gaurī and the others, who are form and the rest in their purity. "Grasping subject" refers to the six, Nairātmyā and the others, who are the eye and the rest in their purity. "Flesh, blood, urine," and so on refer to Pukkasī and the others. "Impurity, bewilderment, bathing, and cleanliness" refer to the goddesses Locanā and the others, who are compassion and the rest in their purity. "Attachment, aversion, delusion, envy, avarice, and pride" refer to the six universal monarchs, Amitābha and the others. "Nothing to be seen" and so on refer to the sentiments (rasa), beginning with the one called the amorous. "Meditation" is the path. "Meditator" is the one who meditates. "What is to be held" has the nature of a friend: it is the qualities of a buddha. "Enemy" is the afflictions, whose nature is to be abandoned; these do not exist.

As for "the innate without ripples" and "not of varied aspects," "ripples" is the nature of true realization, and "without" is emptiness, the joy of the innate. The syllable vi means "free from"; what is free from the nature of variety is so called. The meaning of this is that it is called "the innate without ripples": various natures appear, yet in it there is no phenomenon whatsoever to be adopted, nor anything to be rejected.

Alternatively, these words beginning with "supreme joy" may also be construed according to their literal sense.

To ask about the distinction between the elements and what derives from the elements in that very innate, the text says, "Vajragarbha," and so on; this is indicated by the words "the aggregates derived from the elements." "Without ripples" is the defining characteristic of the mind, and the passage beginning "Through the union of vajra and lotus" teaches that this very mind has the nature of the elements and of what derives from them. The conclusion is stated in the passage beginning "Therefore." There, "bliss" is merely the means to bliss, and that is not reality. Since the bliss born from the two organs arises from the great elements, it is not reality.

With beginners in mind, the nature of the innate is taught in the passage beginning "The two born together": whatever nature is found simply upon being born is the innate. The unchanging gnosis in which means and wisdom, directly present and uncontrived, are complete is called "the innate nature." Alternatively, if one asks how the reality of the innate is to be understood: "nature" is simply one's own bliss; it is free from all the senses, it is emptiness without adopting or rejecting, and it is naturally pure, without beginning, end, or middle. "Innate" is awareness through the nature of wisdom, completely free from the causes of all affliction, and characterized by emptiness, signlessness, and wishlessness. In "the single binding of all aspects," "all aspects" are the various kinds of objects of reference, to the very limit of saṃsāra; "single" means as the nature of great bliss; and "binding" means pervading.

Now, in order to teach unsurpassed reality, the means is stated: "Of the yogin who turns compassion into the means." This is through taking up desire, for it is said, "Because compassion is declared to be the means." In "the seal is free from cause," the seal is wisdom, whose nature is unborn gnosis. What is other than that is the cause, and the seal is free from it. This too has been said:

Free from all conceptual elaboration,
means and wisdom without duality:
if one meditates on that nature with the mind,
one will attain the unsurpassed fruit.

That very meaning is stated in the passage beginning "Emptiness and compassion are not distinct." One's own mind, free from all conceptual thought, is empty. The aspect of fully protecting all sentient beings without exception from their sufferings is compassion, which is a mental factor. Someone may think, "Mind and mental factors are distinct, so how can these two be called not distinct?" In answer, it says "awakening," and so on. Because

both of the two are emptiness, they are indivisible, like a lamp and its light. Therefore, because they are nondual, it is awakening; and because it is mere self-awareness, it is mind. To teach that very point, it says, "There is no mantra recitation, no austerity, no fire offering," and so on, because it has the nature of great bliss, in which all phenomena are indivisible.

This is the explanation of the tenth chapter, from the commentary on the difficult points of Hevajra called The Source of Mindfulness, composed by the master Kṛṣṇa.

To teach that without accomplishing the gazes, such as the felling gaze, one cannot easily draw in sentient beings who are hard to tame, it says, "The evenly wrathful gaze," and so on. The fruit of thoroughly accomplishing the four gazes is stated in the passage beginning "Accomplishing the four gazes": those who have accomplished the four gazes, the felling gaze and the rest, should bring all sentient beings into the three vehicles. "Here one should not kill" means: "What is needed is only to bring them into the teaching of the Buddha; one should not kill." In "the commitment will be utterly broken," the commitment is compassion, because it engages equally with all sentient beings, and its breaking is becoming utterly separated from it. As for "One should do all that is not to be done": in order that one whose nature is great compassion may gather the roots of virtue of all sentient beings without exception and bring them into the teaching, if even the ten virtues are treated as equal, what need is there to mention anything else? In "One should also give up beguiling sentient beings," "sentient beings" are those who have no faith in the teaching; "beguiling" is accumulating roots of virtue ever higher; and "giving up" is discarding the causes of obstacles. The passage beginning "Merely by harming sentient beings" means that by harming sentient beings one does not find the accomplishment of the seal, whereas by benefiting sentient beings every accomplishment comes about.

"From the seven-times-born comes accomplishment" refers to sky-going. "Overthrowing the joy of cessation" means that, when the accomplishment of sky-going has been attained, one constantly unites with the maidens of the vidyādharas (knowledge holders), and through this complete delight arises; so the joy of cessation, whose nature is freedom from desire, is vanquished, and this is what "overthrowing" means. "Sweet voice" means having a deep voice that all beings long for and that captivates the mind. "Beautiful eyes" means having wide eyes that delight all beings. "Fragrance" means being fully endowed with the fragrance of a bodhisattva's incomparable moral discipline.

"A body of great radiance" means a pleasing body, neither too large nor too long, neither too short nor too tall, with the color of Jambūnada gold, praised by all people. "Seven shadows" means that, having taken seven births among humans in unbroken succession, he has seven appearances. "His" means even a little of the flesh and so on of one who is like that. "Merely by eating" means that merely by tasting that properly prepared substance with the tongue, as one eats it, one gains the accomplishment as described.

"In brief" means that only some of the mantras are taught: here they are merely presented one by one, while the extensive version is taught in the twelfth kalpa.

From The Source of Mindfulness, a commentary on the difficult points of the Hevajra composed by the master Kṛṣṇa: the explanation of the eleventh chapter. The commentary on the first part is complete.

"According to the proper procedure" means by the rite of consecration (pratiṣṭhā) taught in the explanatory tantra. On "whose self is Vajragarbha": the five wisdoms are the vajra. Those very wisdoms are the essence (garbha); it is called the essence because, like space, it pervades all phenomena and cannot be taken as an object. One whose very nature is that is so called. On "all buddhas gathered into one": "all buddhas" are Vajrā and the rest, who are the nature of the aggregates, the elements and the sense sources, and that in which they are perfectly gathered into one is so called. To teach that for whatever is done, such as drawing a maṇḍala, in every case one should first perform a pacifying fire offering in order to pacify obstructing spirits, the text says, "Perform the fire offering as it has been taught."

On "In the evening, having purified the image": in the evening, at the first juncture of the night, one should carry out the preparatory rite (adhivāsana), preceded by the purification. The rite of purification for this is taught in the passage beginning "abiding in the sky." If one asks how the mantrin should regard it, the answer is the passage beginning "of one's chosen deity." "The wise one" means wise in the ritual procedures of the maṇḍala and the like. "One who has gone to the far shore of mantra" means one who has previously recited the mantras of the deities thoroughly, in accordance with the rite. The rest should be understood here as well, just as it is found in other treatises.

From The Source of Mindfulness, a commentary on the difficult points of the Hevajra composed by the master Kṛṣṇa: the explanation of the first chapter of the Nairātmyā part.

On the passage beginning "Blessed One, all phenomena": just as a gourd, however it is put into the great ocean, stays in one place, so too in the ocean of saṃsāra, churned by the sea monsters of desire and the rest, how can sentient beings come to accomplishment through nothing more than their own chosen deity, which is like a gourd? That is to say, how can all phenomena be perfected as one single intrinsic nature? This is the opponent's position (pūrvapakṣa).

On the passage beginning "The Blessed One said": "Selflessness" means the Blessed Lady (Nairātmyā). Her yoga is the intrinsic nature of all phenomena as completely pure, and "joined" means fully joined with that. On the passage beginning "or else glorious Heruka": the meaning of "glorious Heruka" has already been explained. These two are differentiated by way of the generation stage, but ultimately not by way of the completion stage. As it is also said:

Possessing form, with faces, arms and so forth;
Ultimately bliss, not possessing form.

The meaning of this is that, on account of those to be trained, in the generation stage they are differentiated by arms, faces, color, shape and so on, but they are not differentiated by the completion stage, whose nature is the great bliss that arises perpetually.

"At night" means while sleeping, that is, when the whole array of the senses has been withdrawn. On "in one's own house": the five aggregates are the house, because they are like a house, in that through one's own conceptual thought they hold the mind, which is neither short nor long. "With the mind of the accomplished ones" means a mind that is free from the pride of being ordinary and fully endowed with the aspect of one's own deity; the meaning is that, by meditating as that divine nature in all circumstances, accomplishment draws near. That is why the text says "washing the feet" and so on.

"I have taught" means "I myself have made the correct rite clear." If one asks, "Of what?", it says "meditative concentration." If one asks, "Of what kind?", it says "that destroys evil," that is, it destroys the sphere of experience, the aggregates and the rest together with their habitual tendencies. On the passage beginning "for the sake of accomplishment": in order that these may be accomplished with certainty, that very practice has been fully determined by divisions such as half a month. On the passage beginning "there is no other means": without realizing the sequence just taught, there is not the slightest other means by which one's own aims and those of others can be

accomplished. That is why the text says "sometimes" and so on, meaning that, with divisions such as a single day as well, one should practice that very awareness and the rest without interruption.

The result is stated: "immediately," that is, at that very instant. "It produces conviction" means it makes one experience it directly. On the passage beginning "fear and madness": these are merely illustrative examples; moreover, the practitioner will not be afflicted by the sufferings of the conditioning factors. "Thus" refers to the characteristics of the path just taught. "When it is practiced" refers to the path, and means when one has made it habitual. On the passage beginning "benefit and harm": the arising of the qualities of the Tathāgata's unsurpassed wisdom is the beneficial result. For those who have not made that path habitual, the arising of birth, aging, sickness, death, sorrow, lamentation, suffering, mental unhappiness and the like is the harmful result. The passage beginning "so that" is easy to understand. "That" refers to having gained the authority to issue commands. "Is able" means through the power of mantras and the like. "Summoned" is to be construed with all of them: gods, humans, asuras and so forth. "Seized" means having taken hold of them. On "conduct": one should practice the conduct of the awareness observance (vidyāvrata). "Oneself" means the mind. This word "firm" is to be understood in terms of particular times and circumstances. "For the sake of conviction" means in order to make it manifest. On the passage beginning "for the sake of enjoyment": it is not to be displayed for the sake of enjoyment.

"That which is renowned" means that by which yogins renowned as supreme perfect buddhahood; and this very mudrā is a terrifying form, because it gives rise to fear in others whose inclination is inferior. The passage beginning "having abandoned the breasts" concerns those who have gained mastery over genuine primordial wisdom: in order to become habituated to all aspects being without essential nature, they transform their form just as they wish. The intent is that, through being preceded by the mudrā as taught and by meditation on the generation stage, one who has the nature of the entire expanse of reality (dharmadhātu) and of beings comes to grasp realization in an instant.

The passage beginning "birth and" states the very nature of accomplishment. Here, wisdom and means are emptiness and the mind whose nature is compassion. "Deathless" means that it is neither increased by birth nor destroyed by activity. "Since means is arising" means this: it is means because

it takes up the desired aim, and it is arising because it abides in all sentient beings and has genuinely arisen; it is great compassion. "Dissolution" means that it is dissolution because, in the manner of the expanse of reality, it no longer appears anywhere. "Wisdom brings existence to an end" means that it clears away all error. "Therefore it is not destroyed by fear" means this: the body accomplished from non-referential compassion, the nature of the completion stage, known as means and wisdom and free from all error, has no fear, because existence has ceased.

On "in suchness there is no birth": suchness is non-referential emptiness and the nature of compassion; since by nature it is unconditioned like space, it has no cause, and so it has no birth. Therefore means and wisdom are not bound by birth and destruction. On the passage beginning "whatever fear and": "whatever" means "of whatever." "Destruction" means separation from causes and conditions. "Dissolution" means the complete reversal of the continuum. On "undefiled": it is not nonexistence.

"By the yoga of the generation stage" refers to the assembly of deities, the aggregates, elements and sense sources completely purified, preceded by the transformation of seed syllables, seats and signs; that itself is the elaboration. On "having made the elaboration like a dream": because the aggregates and so on are, in the ultimate sense, untrue like a dream, even those that are perfectly accomplished, though taught as being by nature merely the antidote to the pride of being ordinary, are simply untrue. "Through elaboration one should make it free of elaboration" means this: having meditated on the elaboration, one should meditate on the nature of the mantras, the deities and so on as emptiness, which is the realization of the nature of great bliss in which all phenomena are indivisible, the self of all, free of elaboration.

What is this that is called "free of elaboration"? Suppose one says that the very absence of an essential nature of elaboration is freedom from elaboration, and someone thinks, "That is not so, because that itself is an elaboration." To this: since what has become devoid of the essential nature of elaboration is established as freedom from elaboration itself, how could it properly be called elaboration? When whatever is the nature of a thing has ceased to be, that thing is not spoken of as having that nature. Therefore the meditation on elaboration enjoined by the buddhas, the Blessed Ones, should be seen as supremely gathering in the ultimate suchness of the mantras, which is free of elaboration. This too is stated:

That itself is mantra recitation and austerity;
That itself is the fire offering and the maṇḍala;
In brief, it has the nature of the gathered mind.

"Like an illusion" means that there is no arising and ceasing in the way the childish imagine; rather, through the force of causes and conditions that are themselves untrue, there is the appearance of arising and so forth. "Like a dream" means that it is emanated from one's own mind alone and does not depend on any other cause. On "like the intermediate existence": when the former existence has passed and the existence of birth has not yet been taken up, this is the intermediate existence (antarābhava). Isolated from karma and afflictions, become utterly clear as the nature of self-awareness, unobstructed in nature, comprehending virtue and non-virtue, and by nature turned toward the state free of obscuration: the meaning is that one should definitely meditate on the wheel of the maṇḍala as being like that.

Stating that the characteristics of all phenomena are perfectly gathered together through the nature of great bliss, it says "black too is bliss" and so on. In the experience of bliss, black and the rest are not perceived as distinct; otherwise, that very bliss arises as the defining characteristic of objects such as black. Therefore that very great bliss is the nature in which all three realms, without exception, are indivisible. Well then, what is that great bliss like? "Born of union" means the undefiled great bliss born from the union of means and wisdom. On "existence is bliss": being of the very character of self-awareness, the existent is bliss. "Nonexistence is bliss" means that, since the apprehended object and the rest are not established, it is the bliss of nonexistence. On "Vajrasattva is declared to be bliss": Vajrasattva too is of the very nature of bliss; the meaning is that there is no other body of Vajrasattva whatsoever, distinct from bliss. On "the yoga of the completion stage": it is without meditation, because its nature is simply the primordial wisdom of everything without exception.

That is why it says, "Completion is without meditation." The meaning of this is that the characteristic of great bliss, in which all phenomena are indivisible and whose nature is free from every error, is completed by nonconceptual primordial wisdom, the expanse of reality. On "Then what need is there for the generation stage?": the generation stage is elaboration, by nature preceded by the transformation of seed syllables and so on, and suchness definitely does not genuinely arise from conceptions such as meditator, object of meditation and meditation. Therefore what need is there for it? The meaning is

that there is no need at all.

On the passage beginning "The Blessed One said, 'How wonderful!'": "how wonderful" expresses amazement. If one asks why, it says "by the force of faith" and so on. The force of faith is mere faith. "Ruined" means having strayed far from the path of mantra; out of love for those beings he says, "Great Being." On the passage beginning "without a body": without realizing the aspect of a body made of the elements, consciousness cannot be grasped, so where would the bliss abide whose nature is the complete perfection of things? Therefore one must definitely accept that great compassion itself, of one taste as the nature of great bliss, appears in forms of various aspects until saṃsāra comes to an end. This too is stated:

As the antidote to ordinariness,
One is fully conceived as a buddha's body;
Once the deity's form has been made habitual,
Through that, vast and various forms
Come within the sphere of those to be trained.
Through the practice of the completion stage,
Through the mind, too, comes buddhahood itself,
In which all conceptions have ceased.

Just as quicksilver is held fast by being combined with something heavy, in the same way is not the jewel of the mind too, whose nature is unsurpassed bliss, grasped by you through properly meditating on the aspect of the deity's form? To illustrate this very point an example is given, the passage beginning "Just as the fragrance that depends on a flower," which is easy to understand. "Likewise, if form and so on were absent" applies the example to the point: it is in dependence on meditating as the deity's form that the nature of bliss is perceived; otherwise there is no bliss. The two exist in mutual dependence.

"Existence": because it has the nature of the aspects of arms, faces and so on. "I am nonexistence itself": because all elaborations appear as having the nature of nonexistence. On "I am the Buddha": he is awakened because all things are realized in their suchness. On the passage beginning "the deluded who": the deluded are those who, through failing to serve and honor a master, have become foolish and hold to error. "Me" is the accomplishment that is the experience of one's own mind alone, and that is what they do not know. For this an example is given, the passage beginning "likewise." "Conviction" is the cause of making it manifest. "Son" means that he holds Vajragarbha close.

On "like a lamp in the darkness": just as the form of even a single burning lamp removes the whole nature of darkness and illuminates the visible things located in that place, so too, preceded by aspirations such as purification through mantras, as the jewel of the mind itself becomes clear, all the darkness of conceptual thought is destroyed; then, at all times and spontaneously, engaging in activities for others and fulfilling the aims of all beings without exception, one abides until saṃsāra reaches its end. Or else: just as, through a lamp, even darkness accumulated over many eons goes nowhere and stays nowhere, and in just that way is naturally stilled, so, son of noble family, the habitual tendencies of ignorance amassed since beginningless time also cease merely by producing the light of primordial wisdom, going nowhere and coming to stay nowhere.

That may be so, but that non-referential bliss is not perceived everywhere; to teach that it genuinely arises through the special yoga of forming the deity and so on, it says "is dependent" and so on. The conclusion is stated in the passage beginning "therefore": by that very sequence it is nonexistent, that is, it does not have the characteristics of faces, arms, color, shape and so on. On "it does not have the form of nonexistence": this is because, on account of those to be trained, it appears in the aspect of faces, arms and so on. For that very reason it is said:

Possessing form, in the aspect of faces and arms;
Ultimately bliss, not possessing form.

The conclusion is stated in the passage beginning "therefore": because all three realms are suchness whose nature is unchanging, they are innate (sahaja). "By the mind of purified aspect" means by the mind established through scripture and reasoning. On "one's own nature itself is nirvāṇa": it is one's own nature itself because by its own mode of being its nature is nirvāṇa; that natural suchness of all phenomena is, with certainty, nirvāṇa by its own mode of being. The passage beginning "the aspect of the deity" is easy to understand.

Suppose one thinks: "If the very nature of the deity's aspect is nirvāṇa, then since it would be accomplished merely by generating it, what is the point of effort such as meditation?" That is true, but on the passage beginning "yet through ordinary habitual tendencies": in reality the realms of sentient beings are empty, but because people are endowed with habitual tendencies of clinging to things as real, they become deluded and suffer, just as the childish

are killed by food whose poison has not been neutralized. Yet once that very poisoned food has been purified by mantras and the like, it becomes a cause of happiness.

Therefore, so as to attain non-abiding nirvāṇa, which comes after all the obscurations of all sentient beings have been destroyed, and so as to abandon ordinary habitual tendencies, one should purify through the suchness of mantra. To show this, an example is given here, the passage beginning "the piece of poison by which." Even by merely tasting poison, people draw near to death; but "one who knows its reality," knowing the nature of poison, draws near to well-being through that same poison.

On "with poison one dispels poison": just as one who knows the nature of poison dispels all poison with poison, so too it is through the poison of the aggregates and so on that people in beginningless saṃsāra experience the sufferings of death and the rest. But those who know the suchness of mantra, though they partake of the poison, do so as deities whose nature is the aggregates and the rest made completely pure. They thus definitely destroy the poison of the aggregates, laden with the habitual tendencies of habituation to sense objects from one birth to the next, and they experience the great bliss of acting for the benefit of others until saṃsāra comes to an end.

On the passage beginning "Just as for one seized by wind": for one seized by the wind of ignorance, if one tastes even a bean's worth of the nectar of the purified sphere of experience, that great wind of means and wisdom dispels the wind of the afflictions. On the passage beginning "existence": "existence" has the character of the body, a transformation of blood, semen and so on, preceded by ignorance. "Is purified" means made completely pure, in such a way that through meditating as the deity's unsurpassed form, the transformation of seed syllables, signs and so on, preceded by the presence of all the Tathāgatas, one also acts supremely for the benefit of others. The defining characteristic of non-abiding nirvāṇa is purified existence.

On the passage beginning "conceptuality": conceptual thought that belongs to the discordant side is conceptuality (vikalpa); it is mental discourse. "Counter-conceptualization" is conceptual thought that serves as an antidote; it is the expression of the suchness of mantra. On the passage beginning "Just as water that has entered the ear": the movement of the mind conceptualizing one's own happiness, suffering and so on, under the influence of what has been heard, is the water; completely clearing away that ordinary

conceptualization with the water of a mind in the aspect of the pure deity is drawing it out. On "Just so, the conceptualization of existence too": once the conceptualization of ordinary hands, face and so on has also been completely purified through the deity's pure aspect, one comes to bring the suffering of all sentient beings utterly to rest, until saṃsāra comes to an end.

On the passage beginning "Just as for one burned by fire": just as those burned by fire have their injury fully relieved by being warmed again at a fire, so too people, burned by the fire of desire stirred up by attachment to self, are tormented by the sufferings of the hells and so on, through actions of body, speech and mind instigated by grasping at a self. "By that very" means by that very action, embraced by emptiness and the skillful means of compassion; "are freed" means they will be liberated. If one asks, "From what?", it says, "from the bondage of existence." The mind whose nature is error is existence; that itself is the bondage of moving on to other existences, and it is from that.

On the passage beginning "by desire": worldly people are bound by attachment, the clinging to existence, the existence of desire and the rest, into which they enter through wanting happiness for "I" and "mine." "By desire itself one is liberated" means this: one becomes liberated through the blameless way of great passion, which has passed beyond the aspect of grasping at "I" and "mine" and which resolves, "I shall worship all the Tathāgatas through the union of passionate love, and I shall establish all sentient beings in undefiled great bliss."

On the passage beginning "contrary": those of the śrāvaka and pratyekabuddha vehicles, who, not fully knowing the nature of all phenomena, have turned back from meditative concentration in which one abides well, and who, clinging to their own nirvāṇa that is merely the cessation of birth, have fallen away from compassion and wisdom, are the "tīrthikas of the buddhas, the Blessed Ones." What they do not know is this: meditation in the way of great passion, the nature in which all phenomena are indivisible, is the cause of unsurpassed, perfect awakening; this they do not know.

On "the single great joy itself": it is joy because its nature is unsurpassed bliss. "Great" means vast, because, inwardly fully satisfying, it pervades without interruption. "Single" is because its nature is nondual. "Divided, it becomes fivefold" means it is divided into five for the sake of beginners. To show this very point it says "from the union of vajra and lotus" and so on, which is easy to understand.

From The Source of Mindfulness, a commentary on the difficult points of the Hevajra composed by the master Kṛṣṇa: the explanation of the second chapter.

On the passage beginning "in the shape of e": that whose shape is that of a letter, namely like e, is so called; it is the bhaga. "Excellent" is because it becomes the cause of the joy and bliss of unsurpassed play. On "adorned in the middle with the letter vaṃ": "in the middle" means within the opening; it is beautified by vaṃ, which is known as "the bird's head." On "the abode of all bliss": "all" is worldly and transcendent bliss, and it has become the place where these arise. On "the casket of the buddha jewel": buddhahood itself is the jewel, because it is hard to find and possesses inconceivable qualities, and the casket is its receptacle. These lines also go on to show that this, whose nature is the Perfection of Wisdom, immeasurable and boundless like space, serves as the support of both the generation stage and the completion stage.

"Master" is to be taken as the master empowerment. Entering the maṇḍala, and being made into a body indivisible from the Tathāgata after the body has first been purified by these, namely the water, crown, vajra, lordship and name empowerments, the knowledge observance (vidyāvrata) with its three pledges, and the prophecy that follows it: this is to be understood as the vajra master empowerment. After that, the secret empowerment is to be conferred. Through this letting fall of a stream of conventional bodhicitta into the center of the lotus of the disciple's mouth, it is to be understood as having the nature of the vajra of fully purified speech. After that, the wisdom-gnosis empowerment is to be conferred. With the purification of the mind coming first, it is to be understood as like the precious jewel of suchness, in which all phenomena are without distinction.

After that the fourth empowerment is taught: "That, just so, is again the fourth." "That" means body, speech and mind thoroughly purified by the master, secret and wisdom-gnosis empowerments. "Again" means that it has become distinctive: since it works solely for the benefit of others until saṃsāra comes to an end, it is the nature of great bliss, profound and vast in its very being. "Just so" means a nature that, by its essential nature, is the mere absence of adopting and rejecting. The meaning of this is that the nondual nature of Mahāvajradhara (the great Vajra Holder) is what is called "the fourth." It also has another particular name, "the permission empowerment," and this is to be learned from the guru's lips.

On "At the end of the supreme, bliss is attained": "the supreme" is supreme joy, and "its end" means after it. "In the very moment, variety is abandoned" means that the very state in which the moments of variety and the rest have been abandoned has the nature of wisdom-gnosis. "Great bliss" is the ultimate bodhicitta preceded by the conventional. "Is to be held" means it is to be rightly held. On the passage beginning "As long as," the meaning is: for as long as it takes to reach the culmination of awakening, make it into a form that completely fulfills the aims of all sentient beings without exception, like a precious wish-fulfilling jewel. On the passage beginning "The disciple": that is, after the wisdom consorts (prajñā) and the disciples have thus been empowered through the correct rite. "The set of acts" means: having first conferred the master empowerment through the set of acts as they have been taught. "Saying this" is to be joined with what was taught earlier, beginning "Great bliss is to be held."

On the passage beginning "This itself": the meaning is that this very unsurpassed great bliss, which abides pervading all sentient beings, is the great gnosis, and nothing other than this is higher. "Nondual," because it is changeless and unerring. "Of dual form," because it appears distinctly as the identity of method and wisdom. "The self of being and nonbeing," because it is profound and vast. "The lord," because it appears distinctly as the intrinsic nature of all. "The stable and the moving," because it abides in the manner of the world of sentient beings and the container world. On the passage beginning "And illusory form": because it appears distinctly, in a variety of forms, in the mind-streams of ordinary beings and others, each according to their fortune.

On the passage beginning "The maṇḍala-wheel," the meaning is this: through method, what is called the "maṇḍala-wheel," whose nature is the gnosis of unsurpassed great bliss, will certainly be attained, without interruption. The explanation of that very maṇḍala, given after a question had been asked, is as follows. On "center": the center (maṇḍa) is the essence. If one asks what that is, it is bodhicitta. If one asks whether it is the conventional mind, what was said is "great bliss": the nature of great bliss, established as the mark of self-awareness and free from the aspects of all conceptual thought, which by another particular name is called ultimate bodhicitta. On the passage beginning "Taking": taking is holding. Because it does that, and because glorious Heruka, Nairātmyā and all the rest, accomplished through the purity of the aggregate of form and the others, are indivisible, that unsurpassed

object of expression is the maṇḍala. The meaning of this is that this union with Nairātmyā and the others is called the maṇḍala because, without interruption until the end of saṃsāra, it holds the essence whose nature is the one great bliss.

On the passage beginning "The wheel": the wheel is an assembly, the assembly of deities. "Is explained as the expanse of space" means that it is explained, that is, taught, as the element of space. "Purifying the sense objects and so on" means rendering such things as form pure as the assembly of deities, in the way that was taught. "The union of vajra and lotus" is the rite that was described; that is, by that method. "Its" means "of the wheel." "Bliss" is simply ultimate bliss. "Becomes manifest" means that beginners definitely experience it.

The passage beginning "You should kill living beings" is explained point by point in the passage beginning "The one mind." Because it has become the lifespan of the three realms, it is "life," and that in which it is present is a "living being." Cutting it off means that it comes to be no more. The undefiled gnosis of great bliss is what is called "the one mind," and that itself is the killing of living beings. "The worlds are to be delivered": through the passage beginning "Sentient beings are indeed buddhas, but," they are to be understood as by nature in nirvāṇa, at peace from the very beginning, by nature stainless like space. That being so, how could they be delivered? It is a false statement. On "The lady's fluid is what is not given": the one taught earlier is the lady, and her fluid is the conventional bodhicitta indivisible from great bliss. Holding these is taking what is not given. On the passage beginning "Another's woman": "another" (para) means supreme. The body that utterly overpowers all three realms is the "woman." Her other particular names are Nairātmyā and so on.

She herself is beautiful with her own light, because she is one's own mind appearing. "Resorting to them" means that one should turn toward them: this is the secret meaning.

On "the end of formations": formations are the aggregate of formations, and its end is the aggregate of consciousness. On the passage beginning "Its nature": because they are free of the nature of one and many, all things are ultimately unarisen, and therefore it is not true. "Not false" means that, because all things without exception merely appear distinctly in the manner of mere self-awareness, it is not false. In this way it is free from both being and

nonbeing.

On the passage beginning "Like the moon in water": in the clear water of a vessel, by virtue of the disc of the moon being present in the expanse of the sky, a second disc of the moon resembling it appears; yet since it is not established as real, it is not true, and since it appears there, it is not false. In the same way, all phenomena too are not true, because they are unarisen; and yet, because they appear distinctly, they are not false either. Thus, in the purified mind itself, by the force of the latent tendencies of former aggregates and so on, appearances such as a mass of fire arise. This is not that former thing itself projected forward, and since it is unarisen, it is not true either. Because it is other than that, and because it does not appear as something separate, the reflection is not false either: it is not utterly nonexistent.

On the passage beginning "For instance, the fire-drill and": when the fire produced from the effort of the fire-drill and the rest is examined one by one, it is not found in them, and because it is unarisen from the very beginning, it is not true. Yet even so, through the coming together of them all it arises, and because the experience of its appearing distinctly, like an illusion, is hard to deny, it is not false. "Thus all phenomena" means that in the same way the aggregates and the rest, too, when analyzed, are mere designations, being free of the nature of one and many, and so are not true; they are emptiness, free of all conceptual elaboration. And since they are held fast by the valid cognition that is the self-awareness of great bliss, they are not false either.

"What is to be eaten" means the five kinds of meat. "What is to be drunk" means bodhicitta. "What may be approached" means the bliss born of sense objects. "What may not be approached" means what transcends sense objects. "Bathing" means washing away the dirt of the body. "Cleansing" means purifying conceptual thought: apart from self-awareness there is no external bathing and the like, fabricated by concepts of the purity and impurity of body and mind, so these are simply not to be done. "The village practice," meaning sexual union, is the bliss that has the nature of the deity: it is not to be given up. "Mantra" is conceptual thought, outer and inner in nature. "Meditative concentration" is correct knowledge, outer and inner in nature. These are not to be taken as objects of focus. On "Sleep is not to be given up": because a person whose body has not been refreshed by sleep cannot carry out tasks, one should be refreshed by it. On "Nor should the senses be restrained": acting, by nature, like the senses accomplished through the purity of each, one should oneself enjoy the objects that accord with them, in order

to overturn ordinary pride. That is why it says the passage beginning "Meats."

Those who were specified earlier as the mother and the rest are specified once more here, in terms of the outcaste woman and the rest; to show this, it says the passage beginning "Low-born." In it, "sport" means this: making all of them consorts indivisible from Nairātmyā and the others, one should sport by entering into union with a mind that has given up fear, shame and the like, in order to perfect the great bliss in which all phenomena are indivisible, and in order to delight all the Tathāgatas with the unsurpassed offering. That is the meaning.

The passage beginning "Friend" teaches that one should not cling to things agreeable to body and mind. "Toward the vicious" means that one should not feel aversion toward disagreeable things. The meaning of this is that one should neither benefit friends nor harm those who are not friends, but should view them, through the form of one's own unsurpassed samādhi, as indivisible from the sameness of all phenomena and from all the Tathāgatas.

On the passage beginning "Of stone and wood": with respect to what is carved from stone and the like, painted, cast in molds and so on, one abandons the concepts of an object of homage, one who pays homage, the act of homage and so forth. Then, having meditated on all phenomena, indivisibly, as the form of one's own samādhi, one accomplishes the collections of merit and gnosis without exception and fully amasses the whole range of worldly and transcendent activities as well, and by that the accomplishment of the unsurpassed Mahāmudrā becomes complete. These points too are confirmed by the passage beginning "Abandoning fire offerings, sacrifices and austerities."

The passage beginning "The low-caste woman" (ḍombī) means that sentient beings, people of low, high and middling rank alike, are to be touched just like one's own body, because they are indivisible from all the Tathāgatas.

The passage beginning "The five nectars" refers to taking the essence (rasāyana): they are to be prepared according to the rite taught in the Saṃpuṭa Tantra and others. To show that yogins should always bless them, it says: "Those" means Amoghasiddhi. "The deities" means Vairocana. "Water" means Akṣobhya. "Blood" means Ratnasambhava. "Bodhicitta" means Amitābha.

Further, in order to pacify illnesses, it speaks of "the self-born flower." On this: all of these having been prepared according to the rite,

The pungent dispels phlegm,
The sweet dispels bile,
The astringent loosens and purges within,
Or else, in the same way, it binds.
The thin dispels wind,
The bitter wholly destroys fever,
The cold relieves hunger, torment
And heat: a marvel indeed!
These, as the great elixir,
The buddhas have rightly proclaimed.

So it is said. And by combining them with one another, all disorders are overcome as well.

On the passage beginning "The coded language": should one wonder, "If one speaks a language that is not commonly known, what use are the terms of ordinary people?", there is the passage beginning "Unknown to the hearers (śrāvakas) and others." That is, the language of the pledge (samaya) taught in the tantra, which is not within the range of those of poor fortune, is one in which the fortunate delight; and because it has become the parlance of those who keep one's own pledge, the yoginīs, who are fully endowed with all gnosis, come to delight in it. "Lotus," because it opens and blooms, is soft and lovely, is fragrant, and is fully endowed with filaments.

This is the explanation of the third chapter, from The Source of Mindfulness, the commentary on the difficult points of the Hevajra composed by the master Kṛṣṇa.

On kakkola: kakkola is a mountain, that is, what lies below. bola is the vajra, that is, the indestructible. mummu is the place, that is, the lotus of the navel. kakkola is wisdom, she whose form is aṃ. By this indication of the first and the last, the Dharma wheel and the enjoyment wheel that lie between them are also to be included. kṛpita is the little pebble, that is, the form of the indestructible mantra. "Densely" means without interruption. "Is struck" means the descent of bodhicitta. On "Compassion makes no clamor of battle": compassion is the indestructible. "Makes" means entering together. "Clamor of battle" is fighting, the clamor of churning with the fire-drill: it is the clamor of that union. On "There meat is eaten": "meat" is the concept of ordinary meat, and "eating" is making it vanish. "Intently" means continually. "And liquor is drunk" means drinking the taste of the nectar of compassion. "O!" is a call to

the yoginīs. The fortunate are certainly to be admitted into that meaning of the fourth. "The unfortunate are to be excluded" means excluding there what is free of passion.

The meaning of the passage beginning "The four equal parts" is that those which, in their purity, bear the names of the Tathāgatas, Vairocana and the rest, are to be satisfied in the manner of the dharmakāya. "Side dishes and śāli rice" means likewise making vanish those that bear the names go kud ha na. The passage beginning "Entering through dance" means that going to the upper and lower places, the dissolving that brings it to a halt, and enjoyment and empowerment are to be understood as having the nature of saṃsāra and nirvāṇa. On "The limbs are adorned with the partless": the partless is the bone ornaments. That, in turn, is bodhicitta, because it is like kunda jasmine. Adorning the body with it is its dissolving. "The corpse is to be placed there" means that, right there, it enters the whole body. "Born on Malaya" (malayaja, that is, sandalwood) is the gathering of the heroes (vīras) and yoginīs whose nature is the channels. "Applied through union" means entering there through the mutual union of those whose nature is the channels, the purity of method and wisdom. On "Therefore the low-born are not to be excluded": the low-born are those who may not be touched, and here they are not excluded.

Alternatively, these words are to be applied, in accordance with their meaning, to the wisdom-gnosis empowerment. kolla means what is beneficial. bolla is the vajra. musmu is below the navel. kakkola is the lotus. "The fortunate" is the end of supreme joy and the beginning of the joy of cessation (viramānanda). "The unfortunate" is the joy that is free of passion. The rest are to be understood literally, in keeping with the oral instructions. Or else they are to be applied to the feast gathering (gaṇacakra). kolla is a special place. bolla is the method. kakkola is the mudrā. mummu means being seated on the left side. The rest are easy to understand.

"Vajradharma" is the song, whose nature is the dharmakāya, gathering into a meaning that no words can exhaust. "Buddha" is to be understood as the illusion-like form body of the undefiled elements, marked with the major and minor marks; it becomes perfect enjoyment (saṃbhoga). "The yoginīs and the Mother Goddesses (Mātṛkās)": taking on a variety of forms according to the particular dispositions of those to be trained is emanation, and that too is the dance.

The signs of accomplishment for yogins who, as in the rite of the feast gathering, turn toward samādhi are taught in the passage beginning "White garlic." On "The mudrā: the sign and the mark": "the sign" is the figure that abides on the crown of the head. "The mark" is a distinguishing emblem. On "indicates the family": she on whom a vajra shape appears is indicated as being of the family of the yoginī Nairātmyā, and the wise should know her as such. Likewise, distinguished by the shapes of a wheel, a jewel, a lotus and a sword, they are shown to be of the families of Vajrā and the rest. "The remainder of all" means the last. "Also," because nothing of its purity whatsoever is meditated upon.

On the passage beginning "Because sixteen": this is because the channels, which have become the antidote to all the darkness of ignorance, which have the nature of the five gnoses and have become the very being of the Tathāgatas, which are the purity of the fifteen moments divided according to the four truths, and in which the vowels of the fifteen digits are complete, are the wheel of deities whose identity is method and wisdom, which is to say, the nature of the path. The nature of Mahāvajradhara, which cannot be apprehended in that, is the sixteen moments purified and brought to fullness. Through this the collections of merit and gnosis are perfected, and the darkness of conceptual thoughts, consisting of all adverse factors and antidotes without exception, is lit up by the light of the jewel of the mind whose aspect is the great bliss in which all phenomena are indivisible. Then, by the force of earlier training through mantra and the rest, it enters spontaneously into all world systems without exception, and in various shapes, colors and modes of conduct it teaches the Dharma to all sentient beings in various sounds and languages, according to those to be trained. This is the partless nature, because it is not the nature of the path.

And why is that? Because at the time of the fifteen moments, the destruction of all the darkness of unknowing has already been accomplished. Therefore the things to be abandoned, the obscurations of karma, of the afflictions, of birth, of gnosis and of the knowable, are by nature completely purified; and as the dharmakāya, a form free of conceptuality, it abides until saṃsāra comes to an end as an identity fully endowed with the body of perfect enjoyment and the emanation body, which fulfill the aims of those to be trained, just as they wish, in the manner of uninterrupted great bliss. It is free of all that is to be abandoned.

The summary is given in the passage beginning "Bodhicitta is." The fifteen seeds, which have become the antidote to the adverse factors and are the purity of the five gnoses, are what consists of the digits. "Bodhicitta is the moon" means the path. On the passage beginning "The form of āli" (the vowels): the dharmakāya, characterized by great bliss, whose nature is the whole of the āli, is āli. On "yoginī": by virtue of that, the yoginī is the identity of perfect enjoyment and emanation, which fulfill worldly and transcendent aims; she is taught as the result.

On the passage beginning "Innate joy": this camphor is called that because its nature is innate. "Inexhaustible" means imperishable. "Fortune" means firmness. "Sky-goer" (ḍāka) means having entered inside the lotus. These too are to be connected with what comes below, beginning "It is not to be taken up with the hand."

On "The method of the maṇḍala-wheel and so on": the assembly of deities that is the purity of the aggregates, elements and sense sources is the maṇḍala-wheel; that is meant, and the words "and so on" take in the binding done with the mudrās that come below, and the like. "And also through the sequence of self-blessing" refers to the blessing of the vajra and the lotus and so on. "Also" means by its being brought into the mind. "Buddha" means Vairocana and the others, whose nature is to seal. "Bodhicitta" means those that are to be sealed. "Vajradhara" means one who holds the vajra whose nature is the indivisibility of all phenomena. "Support" is evaṃ.

"Likewise" means these very things: the aggregates, elements, sense sources and so on, which have taken on the nature of support and supported and are pursued through such adverse factors as self and what belongs to self, are saṃsāra. The nature of the deity, in which that very elaboration of self and what belongs to self has been removed, is nirvāṇa. It is not, as the hearers and others hold, empty in every respect, like the stream of a lamp that has run out, for it is the very nature of saṃsāra, undistorted.

Further, to teach the characteristics of form and the rest, it says the passage beginning "Saṃsāra is form, sound and the rest." Here, although form is of many kinds, in brief it is threefold, divided into the pleasing, the displeasing and the middling. The same is to be applied to sound and the rest. On "Saṃsāra is feeling and the rest": feeling too is of many kinds, but in brief it is threefold, characterized as pleasure, pain and equanimity. Perception too is of many kinds by the divisions of realms, destinies and places of birth, but in

brief it is sixfold, through its nature of apprehending the particular features of things such as form. Formations are of many kinds by the divisions of mental factors, but in brief they are three: virtuous, nonvirtuous and indeterminate. Consciousness too is extremely manifold by the divisions of realms, destinies and places of birth, but in brief it is sixfold by the divisions of the eye and the rest. "Saṃsāra is the very faculties" means the six, the eye and the rest. "Saṃsāra is aversion and the rest" means the afflictions: aversion, delusion, desire and the rest. In the five destinies, above and below, the very mind and mental factors that have been accumulated again and again by karma and afflictions, through clinging to joy and pleasure for oneself, are saṃsāra. What has the nature of birth is saṃsāra; it is not that something characterized as a self, a life principle (jīva), a nourisher (poṣa) or the like exists and cycles on.

"These phenomena are nirvāṇa" means that, since those very phenomena are by nature free of distortion, have become the indivisibility of method and wisdom, and are to be known each by oneself, they are nirvāṇa, in a nature free of elaboration. "Through delusion, the way of saṃsāra" means that when the meaning of reality is not understood exactly as it is, mind and mental factors themselves are saṃsāra. On the passage beginning "When there is no delusion": having no delusion is knowing truly, just as things are. "Purifying saṃsāra" means that, through firm conviction in form and the rest as they are in reality, the distortion that constitutes saṃsāra is reversed, right within saṃsāra, by its own essential nature.

On "She has the nature of the first vowel": she whose nature is the first vowel is "the first vowel," that is, wisdom, she whose form is ā. "The buddhas have declared her to be understanding (dhī)" means: because she has trained the understanding of all the Tathāgatas, she is "understanding"; because they thoroughly know reality, they are "buddhas." "She herself is the Blessed One," because she has the nature of the mirror-like gnosis and the rest. Because she has fully ripened through meditation and goes forward, she is "wisdom." "Through the yoga of the completion stage" teaches the yoga in the same way as the yoginīs' wheel of the generation stage. The passage beginning "She is not long" is because she is free of all shape and the like. "Beyond savor, smell and taste" is because she is not the object of any sense faculty. Because she brings unsurpassed great bliss to perfection, she is "she who brings about innate joy." Because through this meditation of wisdom the yogin of great method is truly generated, it says, "The yogin is generated by her." "One should enjoy her bliss" means one should experience that indivisible nature in

one's own mind-stream. "Together with her, accomplishment is achieved" means that the wisdom just explained is itself the supremely eternal mudrā.

Here the oral instruction is this. Imagine at the navel a red lotus with four petals, open and facing upward. Having meditated on wisdom, she whose form is aṃ, at the center of the lotus, one should then imagine the fourteen vowels there on the other petals, above and below and in the cardinal and intermediate directions. Moreover, if, by the rite as it is taught in the tantra, one contemplates them as fully ablaze and, like an extremely fine thread, unbroken for even a single day, certain conviction will arise; of this there is no doubt.

The passage beginning "Form" refers to the objects from form up to the element of phenomena (dharmadhātu), that is, what has become external in nature. "By wisdom herself" means by her whose nature is the first vowel. "Is enjoyed" means is contemplated.

To set this out in detail, it says the passage beginning "Then the innate nature." On this: "Great bliss," because her nature is incomparable great bliss. She is "the Excellent One" because she accomplishes the aims of the higher states and of the definitive good. She is a "yoginī" because she has this disposition of joining with the mind-streams of all sentient beings. "Wheel" is the maṇḍala that serves as the support. "The path of meditation" means that it is preceded by clear realization (abhisamaya). "The deities" are what has become the supported. "As they arise" means generating them just as the rite prescribes. "The yoginī abiding in the middle of the body" is the three channels located below the navel. The syllable aṃ meditated on there, which binds all phenomena together in a single form, is wisdom, she whose form is aṃ. "As outwardly" refers to the wheel of deities being arrayed in the generation stage by way of the purity of all phenomena. "So inwardly" means that likewise, in the completion stage, there is the wheel of the mantra deities. "Binding" (saṃvara) means that, just as the wheel of deities, in which the things conceived as outer and inner are purified, gathers all phenomena into a single mode, so the completion stage also gathers them. This is what is specified as "perfectly clear."

On the passage beginning bola: bola is the vajra. Its bliss is the gnosis that has entered within the jewel. That itself is the Great Seal (Mahāmudrā), because it seals all phenomena with a single identity. On "the vajra source": the vajra is nonreferential gnosis, and that itself is the source, because it has become the

ground from which the wheel of deities is generated. "The self of method," because it goes to the culmination of gnosis. Alternatively, bola is the vajra. Its bliss is what has come about at the beginning of supreme joy and at the beginning of the joy of cessation. Its nature, called the Great Seal, is wisdom, she whose form is aṃ. "Vajra" means indestructible. On "source" (āyatana): aya is consciousness, and tana is expansion, that is, dissolution, enjoyment and empowerment. "The self of method" means approaching the identity of the places and the rest.

On "The union of these secrets": the secrets are lalanā and rasanā, the purity of method and wisdom. Their union comes about through meditating on them as nondual. On "External union is not taught": this means there is no meditation on the union of the wheel of yoginīs as outer deities. This too has been said:

Through the union of the vowels and consonants,
Outer union is to be rejected.

Now one may wonder: "If it is only this inner union, how can that be? Why, then, was the passage beginning 'Abandoning the form of a woman, it is transformed into another's form' taught?" That is true, but what is intended there is this: those who are endowed with the yoga of Nairātmyā through the very nature of their own mind alone, and who, by way of the observance of the consort (vidyā) for which they have received permission from the guru and others, have gained mastery over the mind in which all the Tathāgatas are indivisible, will abide fully endowed with gnosis, as has been taught, for a single session, a day, half a month, a month, a year, or even thousands of eons.

The passage beginning "The three bodies" teaches that the dharma, enjoyment and emanation bodies, in the form of the wheels, are to be fully understood. "To the multitude" means all sentient beings who are turned toward birth. "By this" means by being fully endowed with what has just been explained. All that possess life are "sentient beings." All that are free of adventitious stains and luminous are "buddhas." "Are buddhas indeed" means that in nature they are indivisible from those who have realized purity. "Without doubt," because things such as consciousness, being by nature empty, have the nature of unsurpassed, self-aware suchness, and because it is established by valid cognition that this very gnosis, by the force of the devotion of those to be trained, shows itself to others as the form body. This

too has been said: "All sentient beings possess the essence of the Sugata." This shows that all sentient beings are by nature completely pure.

To give the reason for applying that very purity, it says the passage beginning "The ten months are the ten grounds." Because the first ground and the rest are purified and increase, each higher than the last, until they reach their culmination, the being is the lord of the ten grounds. Therefore the essential nature of the karma, afflictions and births produced by mistaken conceptions is adventitious: there are no stains in the nature itself, and it is to be joined to the very nature that is completely pure.

To tell what happened once the nature of beings had been heard from the Blessed One, it says the passage beginning "Then." "The goddess" (devī), because she shines without interruption in the mind-streams of beings such as goddesses. "All" means however many have the nature of the purity of body and the rest. "Were supremely amazed" means: having realized that the suchness of ordinary beings and the suchness of unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening are indivisible in their essential nature, they became supremely amazed; this is "attaining amazement."

"Fainted" means: because they abided in the nonconceptual meditative absorption, indivisible and of the nature of great bliss, all mind and mental factors fainted, that is, became utterly unmoving. "Were frightened" means: they were frightened because the teaching that the very limit of saṃsāra is by nature nirvāṇa and is the supremely profound Great Seal (mahāmudrā) cannot be understood by those of inferior faculties and is hard for the mind to enter. "Fell to the ground" means: because they attained the reality of phenomena, which completely cuts off the aggregates and the rest together with their habitual tendencies, they took fright and fell to the ground with all their limbs. "Trembled" means: by hearing the Dharma called Hevajra, the swift method that wholly transcends every world, the supreme great secret, difficult and unsurpassed, they came to experience the eighteen great signs, trembling and the rest.

Again, having made them fully endowed with the good fortune to hear the Dharma, so very hard to find and inconceivable, he explained their own essential nature just as it is, so that they regained their life; and his raising them up is the passage beginning "Earth": the sisters whose nature is earth, water, wind and fire. "Goddesses" is a word of address. The intrinsic nature is precisely what no one at all knows, and "listen to its elaboration" is an

exhortation.

Summing up that very point stated before, he says the passage beginning "Sentient beings are indeed buddhas, but": that is, they are by nature in nirvāṇa, and are of a nature indivisible from the Dharma Body (dharmakāya).

Someone may object: "If they are established as buddhas by nature, it follows that mantra recitation, meditation and the like are pointless." In answer he says, "obscured by adventitious stains." That is, their own intrinsic nature has been made unclear by the adventitious obscurations of karma, affliction and birth. This shows that those who strive by means of meditation, recitation and the like are indeed buddhas, by the very nature of unsurpassed method and wisdom.

Should one think, "Since the mind is by nature completely pure, how can it become stained?", that is not so. Just as space, though by nature void, becomes stained by dust, haze, clouds and the like, so too this Jewel of mind, though by nature completely pure, becomes stained by the conceptions of self and mine to which it has grown accustomed from one birth to the next since beginningless time. And it has been said: "It is true that in this multitude of sentient beings there is not a single being endowed with the primordial wisdom of all the Tathāgatas; yet, clinging to conventions, they do not directly know the primordial wisdom of the Tathāgata. When they are freed from all conventions, then the self-arisen primordial wisdom of the Tathāgata becomes clear, without obstruction."

Regarding "if virulent poison is eaten": virulent poison is a particular kind of poison; if one eats it, one is overcome by stupor. If one asks, "Whose?", it is "whoever in the unknowing world." "The unknowing world" means those who lack the mantras and the like that serve as the antidote to poison. As for "free of delusion and the reality": whoever knows the reality of the mantras and the like that serve as its antidote is free of delusion and knows the reality. "He is freed from it" means: whoever knows reality is freed from the delusion of the poison of saṃsāra, and not otherwise. This is the sequence just taught. For one who knows method and wisdom and has fully realized them, saṃsāra is turned back. "Having made Hevajra one's own" means the consummate realization handed down from one guru to the next. "Ignorance and the rest" means that one is not seized by the mass of suffering that runs from ignorance up to old age and death. "Nor is one bound by delusion and the rest" means that one is not bound by the nooses of delusion and the rest either: self and

mine, happiness and suffering, and so forth.

As for the passage beginning "Not a buddha," this means that there is not a single sentient being who is not of the nature of a buddha. If one asks why, he says the passage beginning "Because." "Awakened" means: by virtue of self-awareness alone, all these are by nature fully awakened in an unerring way, and all sentient beings have the nature of understanding. If one asks, "That being so, how do they come to go into the destinies?", he therefore says the passage beginning "Hell." Its meaning is this: there are those who are engulfed in the blazing fire of the utterly unbearable suffering of the hells and the other abodes conjured by non-virtuous karma. The very nature of those beings is at all times, by its essential nature, nirvāṇa, and in the manner of great bliss it is indivisible, as the nature of the Dharma Body. That is what is meant.

Regarding "because they do not know bliss": because the nature of bliss cannot be understood when it is elaborated without relying on the conventions of deities and the like, for that reason the Tathāgatas too employ conventional designations. As for the passage beginning "In any other world system," the meaning is that, apart from the intrinsic nature of the unsurpassed mind, no nature of a buddha at all is found in any other world system. Therefore he says the passage beginning "Mind itself": mind itself, by nature luminous, once freed from the stains of desire and the rest, is buddha.

As for the passage beginning "Butchers, bamboo workers": its meaning is that even butchers and the like, who constantly pursue violent deeds, if they meet a virtuous friend who has entered the path of Hevajra, will cut through the whole net of conceptual thought and before long attain unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening. As for the passage beginning "Fools, obscured by not knowing": to be deluded by grasping at self and mine, which is preceded by not knowing karma and its results, the truths and the Three Jewels, and not to have pleased the guru, is the nature of a fool. Because such a one does not know the path just taught, he circles through the higher and lower destinies.

As for "having obtained the method of Hevajra," the meaning of this, moreover, is that whoever thoroughly purifies entities such as form through the method of Hevajra, which swiftly brings awakening to completion, will attain unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening before long, even while still remaining in saṃsāra. The passage beginning "Pukkasī is declared to be earth" is easy to understand.

This is the explanation of the fourth chapter in The Source of Mindfulness, the commentary on the difficult points of the Hevajra composed by the master Kṛṣṇa.

In the passage beginning "Then": because he establishes those to be trained in the rank of a king of Dharma, he is the "King." Because he smashes the mountain of conceptual thought, he is "Vajradhara." Because he is the embodiment of the profound and the vast, he is "Hevajra." Because he teaches those to be trained in ways suited to them, he is the "Lord." "Whose self is the intrinsic nature of all aspects" is said because he is the intrinsic nature of outer and inner entities in their complete purity. "Maṇḍala" means the maṇḍala that is drawn. The passage beginning "In Sukhāvatī" (the Blissful) is said because it involves the practice of sexual union. "It is the intrinsic nature of all aspects" means that it is the essence of all the deities who are the elements and what derives from the elements, in their purity. "The mind vajra" means the causal Vajradhara. "By the seed" means by the hūṃ resting upon the mark into which the conventional awakening mind has been transformed. As for the passage beginning "Encircled by fifteen," it is precisely the wheel of yoginīs taught earlier, with the two-armed form and so on; this is to be understood from the passage that comes later, beginning "One tier, with four doors." "He fully revealed the maṇḍala" should be looked at in its context further on, in the passage beginning "Then the Teacher of great wisdom."

To show the gathering in of all sentient beings without exception, it says, "Fully trampling the four māras." This means that the four māras are trampled by the four feet. Natural nirvāṇa, nonabiding nirvāṇa, nirvāṇa with the remainder of the aggregates, and nirvāṇa without remainder: these four should be understood as the four feet. Then it says, "He terrifies even the terrifying." In the passage beginning "Garland of heads," the garland of heads is the full fifty letters in their purity; because with it he steals away the minds of fortunate people, it is a "necklace." "Abiding on the sun" means the form that abides in objectless great compassion. Because he sends out emanations in all kinds of forms, he is "engaged in dance." By virtue of his intrinsic nature as the purity of the twelve links beginning with ignorance, he is the "holder of the crossed vajra." "Black in color" will be explained below. Because he frightens those of inferior faculties and without faith, he is "terrifying." Because he teaches the Dharma to those to be trained through all kinds of sounds and languages, he is "emitting hūṃ." Because he is turned toward those to be trained, it is "from his own mouth." Because he is the embodiment

of the ultimate mind, his "body is thoroughly smeared with ash." "Evenly joined in absorption through joy" is said because method and wisdom are perfectly united, preceded by supreme joy. "In union with Nairātmyā" (Selflessness) is said because he unites beings as one in the selflessness of phenomena.

He states the conclusion with the passage beginning "Unruffled." That unruffled state, moreover, should be understood as twofold, divided into reality with an object of focus and reality without an object of focus. "In the delightful city, you and I" is stated here treating cause and result as indivisible. If one asks, "Does this not contradict what is said elsewhere, 'The form of the sattva arises; one should meditate on it as lord of the maṇḍala,' and so on, and 'Gaurī and the rest arise from this'?" it does not, for that very causal Vajrasattva is the lord of the maṇḍala, and Gaurī and the rest should be seen as arising from him.

The passage beginning "Its beginning" means that the parts of beginning, end and middle are not apprehended; the meaning of this is that it is free from time, place, direction and so forth. In the passage beginning "Existence and," existence has the characteristic of arising, abiding and perishing; it is without that. As for "Not nirvāṇa," nirvāṇa is the nature in which the continuum of all entities is cut off; it is not that either. "This is the sublime great bliss" means that this itself is the supreme great bliss, by virtue of self-awareness that is always present. As for "Not other," "other" is the intrinsic nature of external form and so forth; it is not that. As for "Not self either," "self" is the intrinsic nature of one's own initiating, persisting and completing; it is not that either. In the passage beginning "The supreme and the end," these are supreme joy and the ceasing that faces toward arising, and it lies in the middle of them. Because it has no essential nature of desire or of freedom from desire, it is "empty." Because it is known and experienced by oneself, it is "not empty." Because it has the defining characteristics of body, speech and mind, it is "Heruka."

This is the explanation of the fifth chapter from The Source of Mindfulness, the commentary on the difficult points of the Hevajra composed by the master Kṛṣṇa.

As for the passage beginning "By what rite": one may ask, "Since it says, 'What I have not taught to buddhas, to bodhisattvas, or to anyone,' it shows the tantra to be hard to find and unsurpassed. How is it, then, that here he sets

forth rites such as those for painted images, just as in the Action Tantras and the like?" That is so, but it should not be rejected here, because if one paints on cloth, as taught, the deities of the assembly and so forth, it becomes a great mass of merit for yogins; and moreover, for meditators the hands, feet and so forth will certainly become clear, and so the fruit of awakening will swiftly be accomplished.

This is the explanation of the sixth chapter from The Source of Mindfulness, the commentary on the difficult points of the Hevajra composed by the master Kṛṣṇa.

As for the passage beginning "Then the goddess asked him": in view of the utter affliction of the world-realms, he said, "I shall explain the book," and so on, in order to inspire faith in those tormented by great desire, and for the sake of those who delight in books. As for "fortune": although the scriptures of the Tathāgata are indeed to be taught here, "the supreme great secret" is to be kept most carefully concealed among the fortunate; therefore he spoke the passage beginning "On the road," to set it apart. The measure of the book is given in the passage beginning "On birch bark, twelve finger-widths." In the passage beginning "The book and": if the book and the painted images are shown to those without fortune, then, because this teaching is supremely profound, not the domain of śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas, and extremely hard to find, they, for lack of understanding, will think and say, "This was not spoken by the Buddha. Rather, it was spoken by Māra in order to deceive beings." Because of that, they will fall into the hell without respite for an immeasurable time. And the mantrin too, by not guarding it in this way, transgresses his pledges (samaya), and he will by no means obtain accomplishment, even in other lives. "Where" means in a place as prescribed. "If it is eaten" concerns the feast gathering (gaṇacakra): it means if it is eaten by those intent on meditative concentration. "Accomplishment will be gained" means that one comes to have a body inseparable from all the Tathāgatas. As for "He accomplishes all desired aims": "desired" means what all sentient beings hope for in their minds and pray for. "All aims" means worldly and transworldly aims; he accomplishes these effortlessly and without conceptualizing.

This is the explanation of the seventh chapter from The Source of Mindfulness, the commentary on the difficult points of the Hevajra composed by the master Kṛṣṇa.

In the passage beginning "Thereupon the yoginī asked": as for "beings who are vicious and hard to tame," "vicious" means that they delight in saṃsāra, and "hard to tame" means the adherents of other schools. "What must be done for them to be tamed?" means, "How are they to be brought into the teaching of the Tathāgata?" In the passage beginning "First, the fasting vow": first, by means of talks on suffering, impermanence and the like, one should arouse weariness with saṃsāra and speak in praise of the fasting vow (poṣadha), and, beginning by conferring the fasting vow, introduce them into the three vehicles according to their fortune; after that, one should have them take up the five bases of training and so forth. As for "To them teach the Vaibhāṣika": "to them" means to those who possess the bases of training. "Vaibhāṣika" means the view that speaks in terms of particulars. In brief, it declares that the things that make up the container world and sentient beings are conditioned and momentary, which serves as the antidote to belief in the everlasting and the like. As for the system of the śrāvaka Sautrāntikas, in brief: since material things cannot appear by their own essential nature, consciousness itself, having an aspect steered by the object, abides divided into knower and known; and because it appears as objects such as blue and yellow, it is designated as the object itself. Thus, relying on these two systems, one directly realizes the characteristic of the selflessness of the person, who, with karma and afflictions as cause, has the nature of the arising of the aggregates, elements and sense sources, and who wanders, with defilement, among the many different kinds of realms, destinies and modes of birth. Moreover, being restrained by the prātimokṣa vow, and having cultivated the samādhi of the four truths taught in the chapter on the Vajra Family, one abandons the afflictions and tastes the awakening of a śrāvaka or the awakening of a pratyekabuddha.

As for "Then the Yogācāra": the Yogācāra system holds the three realms to be merely one's own mind. Through the force of habitual tendencies accumulated from one birth to the next since beginningless time, the aspects of apprehended objects such as blue, and of self and mine, appear as distinct. As for "After that, one should explain the Madhyamaka": in the Madhyamaka system, that very consciousness is by nature luminous, and since it is void of all objects, it is free from apprehended and apprehender; and by its nature it is empty of every basis for clinging to it as merely the essential nature of individual self-awareness. They hold that through this as well, one becomes familiar with the characteristic of the two kinds of selflessness, fully gathers

the accumulations of merit and wisdom over incalculable eons, enters gradually upon the grounds beginning with the Very Joyful, and so attains unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening, whose nature is the powers, the fearlessnesses and the rest. "The way of mantra" means the various classes, suited to those to be trained, such as the Action and Conduct Tantras. Having heard and understood these, "after that, one should train in Hevajra," and so on. Here, Hevajra is the cause of attaining unsurpassed reality swiftly and without hardship, and even merely hearing and reflecting on it swiftly perfects all good qualities. Having understood it well, if a mantrin who is unimpaired by downfalls, and who has the intention to free sentient beings out of great compassion, makes his meditation on it directly manifest, then in this life or in other lives he will attain the awakening called Mahāmudrā (the Great Seal), further distinguished by its nature of unsurpassed great bliss. Of this there is no doubt; one should not hesitate. That is the meaning.

This is the explanation of the eighth chapter from The Source of Mindfulness, the commentary on the difficult points of the Hevajra composed by the master Kṛṣṇa.

In the passage beginning "Then," "opening the union" means treating each separately. In the passage beginning "By merely knowing which": "by merely knowing which, the practitioner" means that, with great compassion going before, he will attain Mahāmudrā, that which is called "accomplishment."

He teaches this in the passage beginning "The target." Having generated great compassion for all sentient beings, one is to act through the yoga of Heruka, with a wrathful and fierce mind. As for "the Sage and": because he is mindful of the welfare of others, he is the Sage (muni), namely the Blessed One Mahāvajradhara. In the passage beginning "who harms the teaching," "person" means a sentient being. Suppose one who commits such harsh deeds cannot be turned back from the causes of suffering, even though one has tried to turn him back by first gratifying him with conciliatory means and the like and by entreating him. Then, if one addresses to the Blessed Ones the words beginning "Hear me!", they will release him out of compassion. After that the mantrin, steadfast of mind, in accordance with the oral instructions, invites the host of deities dwelling in that person's body, speech and mind, and requests the deities whom he has made to enter his own body, speech and mind to depart. Having made that person's body like an empty house, he visualizes him with face turned downward, vomiting blood, trembling, and with hair loosened. He imagines in that person's heart the seed syllable of fire, blazing

unbearably like the fire at the time of the world's destruction, in the nature of burning the body all the way up to the brain. Then, having inserted a needle ablaze with fire into the anus, he recites the mantra oṃ ghu svāhā and meditates that the root of the navel is drawn out. If he imagines that after death that person's consciousness is born, through the power of the mantra and so forth, in the buddha-field of Akṣobhya, then this will succeed here without any doubt.

If one objects, "If even one whose very nature is compassion acts in this way, how is he not on a par with those who perform sacrifices? There is no difference at all," it is not so. When people, driven by desire and the like, engage in deeds of body, speech and mind that harm others, that is certainly nonvirtue, and through it they are born in the three lower realms. Here, however, one acts out of great compassion, free from grasping at self and mine, having become emptiness; and so drawing out the thorn of suffering becomes a cause of happiness for the target in the world beyond. How, then, could deeds of body and speech undertaken in this way for the benefit of all sentient beings become nonvirtuous deeds? Since they are purely virtuous, how could the compassionate one be like those deluded sacrificers who, wanting heaven for themselves, kill livestock and the like? It is also said:

Wishing to make into vessels
those people who are not vessels,
they guard the teaching of compassion,
not out of hatred, not out of attachment.

And again it is said:

If by a single suffering
one wishes to remove the suffering of many,
then the compassionate one, for the sake of self and others,
should remove those sufferings.

In the passage beginning "Existence": because it gives rise to the higher and lower destinies, it is "existence," that is, the mind. Its yogin is one in whom the four immeasurables, loving-kindness and the rest, are boundless, and who, trained through meditative concentration and wisdom, has mastered the objectless nature. "Delightful": because through the perfection of aspiration he accomplishes the welfare of all sentient beings in a way that captivates their minds, he is "delightful." "He grants nonconceptual accomplishment" means that, having first fulfilled the aims of higher rebirth for all sentient beings

without exception, he bestows the accomplishment of unsurpassed reality, which casts all conceptual thought far away.

In "Look, goddess," "look" means "understand!" "The jewel" means the precious wish-fulfilling gem. "Its form massed with garlands of flame" means a form adorned with light rays that captivate the minds of all sentient beings. Although it is such, beings under the sway of unknowing do not see it. "Unpierced, it is powerless" speaks of a gem that has not been pierced, and serves to make the power of the wish-fulfilling gem understood. "Powerless" means that it has no power to avert the sufferings of sentient beings, such as poverty. "Pierced" means a gem that has been pierced: because it is able to fulfill all aims without exception, when it is thoroughly pierced it "grants what is desired." Here "what is desired" means the aims that all sentient beings hope for in their minds. Where it says "thus," some versions read "fully delivers from foes." There, "foes" means the sufferings of poverty and the like, and "delivers" means sets wholly apart. "Likewise the jewel of saṃsāra" means the jewel of sentient beings. "What is desired" is so called because it is to be desired: it is the very nature of method and wisdom. Or again, "what is desired" is so called because it is to be enjoyed: form and the rest. "To be cultivated" refers to the good qualities, that is, possessing perfected qualities such as the mirrorlike wisdom.

If one asks, "What becomes of it if it is not purified now?" he answers with the passage beginning "The impure." "Impure" refers to those in whom the cataract of unknowing has not been cleansed by the forms of glorious Heruka and the rest; "becomes poison" means that they are bound in saṃsāra again and again. "Pure" means purified by the reality of mantra; "becomes like nectar" means that, in that very saṃsāra, he brings to perfection for all sentient beings the fruit of fearlessness.

In the passage beginning "By what form": as for "the eyes of compassion," the purity of the eyes was taught earlier as "the three vajras." There, purity was stated merely in terms of the number of eyes; here the purity of their color is taught. Because the realms of all sentient beings without exception are beautified with the dye of his compassion, it says, "The eyes of compassion are red." Because he focuses on all sentient beings without exception with a mind of loving-kindness, "his black limbs are a heart of loving-kindness." In the passage beginning "The means of attraction": the means of attraction are that by which he leads all sentient beings into the three vehicles, namely giving, pleasant speech, consistency in aims, and acting toward a common purpose.

As for "four feet," here the purity of number is stated, the purity of the feet merely as such. That the feet are the purity of the māras has already been explained; it comes up here incidentally.

"The eight faces are the liberations" means that the eight faces should be understood as the eight liberations. To show that those who are hard to tame are not tamed by the peaceful mood, and so must be tamed by moods such as the erotic, he says, "The wrathful one tames the wicked." In this line, he is wrathful toward those who destroy karma and its results, the truths and the Three Jewels; that is, he acts with aversion. As it is also said:

To beings who are hateful and wicked
one should not apply even peaceful means.

In the passage beginning "Flesh," what was said earlier, in the passage beginning "Flesh is declared to be Pukkasī," should be understood as the purity of the elements. This passage, beginning "Flesh is to be made Pukkasī," also shows the purity of what is derived from those very elements.

Because the mantras cannot be known without doubt except as explained in a code that lies beyond the range of the unfortunate, he teaches the extraction of the mantras. In the passage beginning "Vajradhara, the great": because it is indivisible, it is "vajra," and because he possesses it, the one whose nature is the five wisdoms is "Vajradhara," the Vajra Holder. Because it is nonconceptual, it is the "heart." "Body" is a body merely in the sense of being its embodiment. Because he has become great, he is "great," since he accomplishes the aims of sentient beings without exception.

"Vairocana" means oṃ. "On the fourth of the warm ones" means hā. "It is to be beautified by Pukkasī" means by u. "Pressed down by the empty" means the dot (bindu). "White in color" means that it is to be made white in color. svāhā is at the end.

"The lord of letters" means oṃ. "Khecarī" means aṃ. svāhā is at the end.

"The first of the Vedas" means oṃ. "On the second of the first" means kha. "The empty" means the dot. svāhā is at the end.

Vairocana is oṃ. "On the third of the second" means ja, joined with ra. "Adorned by the Water Lady" means i. The empty is the dot.

"The sovereign of letters" means oṃ. "The third of the fifth" means ba. "Vajraḍākinī" means u. The empty is the dot, and at the end is svāhā.

"The eldest letter" means the letter oṃ and hūṃ, and svāhā is at the end. "The family of delusion" means oṃ, then ghu, and svāhā is at the end.

"First, Vairocana" means oṃ. "The first of the first" means kā. "Vajraḍākinī" means u. "On the third of those standing at the end" means la. "Vajraḍākinī" means u. "On the foremost of the first" means ka. "Vajraḍākinī" means u. "On the third of those standing at the end" means la. "Again, that very one, fully joined" is also la. "Caurī above" means e. "After that, join the letter hri" is hrī. svāhā is at the end.

"oṃ first, the third of the fourth" means da. "Caurī" means e. "The fourth of those standing at the end" is va. "One should join picuvajra." "The fourth of heat" is hā. "The Fragrant Lady" means u. "Pressed down by the empty" means the dot. "Threefold" means hūṃ, which is to be recited three times. "And the second of the fifth" means pha. "The first of the third" means ta. svāhā is at the end.

Vairocana is oṃ. "Having joined jvala jvala, on the fourth of the fifth" means bha. "The first of those standing at the end" means ya. "The Great-Bellied Lady" means o. "On the fourth of the warm ones" means ha. "Vajraḍākinī" means u. "Pressed down by the empty" means the dot. "Threefold" means reciting hūṃ three times. "On the second of the fifth" means pha. "The first of the third" means ṭa. svāhā is at the end.

"Vairocana" means oṃ. "On the first of the first" means ka. "The inner Gaurī" means i. "On the first of the third" means ṭa. "The inner Gaurī" means i. "Twofold" means saying it twice. "On the third of the fifth" means ba. "The third of the second" means ja. "The Oblation-Eater" (Agni, the fire god) means ra. "Three hūṃ" means reciting hūṃ three times. "The second of the fifth" means pa. The first of the third is ṭa. svāhā is at the end.

"Vairocana" means oṃ. "The first of the fourth" means ta. "The Oblation-Eater" means ra. "Vetālī" means e. "On the third of those standing at the end" means la. "The Great-Bellied Lady" means o. "On the first of the first" means ka. "The first of those standing at the end" means ya. "Vajrā" means a. "Caurī on kṣa" means e. "The first of the fifth" means pa. "The fourth of the warm ones" means ha. "Vajraḍākinī" means u. "Pressed down by the empty" means the dot. "Threefold" means three hūṃ, and phaṭ and svāhā are at the end.

"Nairātmyā" means a. "The first of the first" means ka. "The first of the second" means ca. The first of the third is ṭa. The first of the fourth is ta. The first of the fifth is pa. The first of those standing at the end is ya. The first of

heat is śa. "Vairocana first" means oṃ. svāhā is at the end.

"The second of those standing at the end" means ra. "The letter kṣa" means kṣa. "Twofold" means rakṣa rakṣa. "Three hūṃ" means hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ. "Vairocana first" means oṃ. svāhā, linked with the letters phaṭ, is at the end.

"First, Vairocana" means oṃ. "The end of vajra" means a, accompanied by the request to depart.

"Vairocana first" means oṃ. "After it, kāro mukhaṃ, and": "the third of the warm ones" means sa; "the fourth of those standing at the end" means va; "the Oblation-Eater above" means ra. "After dharmāṇāṃ, O Vajra, supply ādyānudpannatvāta." oṃ āḥ hūṃ phaṭ svāhā.

This is the explanation of the ninth chapter from The Source of Mindfulness, the commentary on the difficult points of the Hevajra composed by the master Kṛṣṇa.

As for "Then, uniting all dharmas as one": "all dharmas" means the ten powers and the rest, and "uniting them as one" means "having the nature of one." As for "He is declared to be called Vajrasattva": "vajra" is the unsurpassed mind, and because he is relied upon by those to be trained, he is its sattva. As for "Nairātmyā": because she is emanated as the intrinsic nature of wisdom free of conceptual elaboration, she is Nairātmyā. "Maker of light" means causing them to turn toward their own objects. In the passage beginning "For immobilizing, of crystal," one should fill it out as "The recitation for immobilizing is to be done with a rosary of crystal," and so on. "For immobilizing" means that it is to be used for the recitation of the rite of immobilizing. "Or else, the śva at the end" means that in rites such as immobilizing one should eat the five pledge substances, as they are obtained.

This is the explanation of the tenth chapter from The Source of Mindfulness, the commentary on the difficult points of the Hevajra composed by the master Kṛṣṇa.

As for "From the base of whose nameless one": the nameless one is the ring finger. The one at the base of whose ring finger a sign such as a vajra appears has the nature of the family of Akṣobhya or of the others. Having shown by these marks which family each belongs to, he now states the division by color, saying, "The yogin who is black in color," and so on. It should be understood that for the person whose limbs are black in color, the deity is Akṣobhya. Whoever is predominantly fair has the nature of Vairocana. Whoever is

predominantly dark green has the nature of Amoghasiddhi. Whoever is predominantly pale yellow is Ratneśa (Ratnasambhava). Whoever is reddish yellow is certainly Amitābha. Whoever is whitish yellow has the nature of Vajrasattva.

Moreover, it should be understood that the Blessed One glorious Heruka himself is taught as Akṣobhya and the rest. That is as follows. Because he neither falls away from his own samādhi nor wavers from it, he is Akṣobhya, the Unshakable, that is, glorious Heruka. Because he shines forth in distinct ways for those to be trained, according to their fortune, he is Vairocana, the Illuminator. Because he teaches without error, he is the Buddha. It is a family only in the sense of a particular state. As for "Amoghasiddhi": "Amogha" means fruitful; because he bestows on those to be trained the fruit of unfailing accomplishment, he is Amoghasiddhi. As for "Ratneśa," the Lord of Jewels: because he delights in all sentient beings and loves them, he is Ratneśa. As for "Amitābha," Immeasurable Light: "light" is radiance, whose nature is higher rebirth and the definitive good; because that is endless and measureless, it is "immeasurable." As for "sattva": because he has supreme power to accomplish the welfare of sentient beings, he is a sattva, that is, Vajrasattva. Thus it should be understood that the Blessed One glorious Heruka himself abides divided into each of these families, because he is the lord of all the families.

In the passage beginning "Moreover, see them as not other, as oneself," it should be understood that this is also taught, once more, by the passage beginning "All sentient beings are indeed buddhas." And it is also said:

Beings who are lowly, middling or exalted
should not be held in contempt.

As for "vast accomplishment": "accomplishment" is that whose nature is Mahāmudrā. "Vast" means extremely extensive, that is, unceasing. "Hearing" is the wisdom that has entered within the vajra jewel. If one asks what comes of that, it says, "He becomes equal to all buddhas." Here "all buddhas" are Vairocana and the rest. "Equal" is said because there is no difference in their qualities, such as the unshared qualities. As it is also said:

In their accumulations and their Dharma body,
and in their conduct for the benefit of beings,
all buddhas are declared to be equal,
but not in lifespan, family or teaching.

This is the explanation of the eleventh chapter from The Source of Mindfulness, the commentary on the difficult points of the Hevajra composed by the master Kṛṣṇa.

In the passage beginning "Then," "abode" means the abode that is the city of nonabiding nirvāṇa. "Joy" means the unsurpassed absorption of the Tathāgatas, which she bestows. "Goddess" is said because she is the embodiment of exceedingly radiant bliss. "Having manifold forms" is said because, out of great compassion, she sends forth manifold emanations for those to be trained. "Delightful to the mind" is said because she captivates the minds of fortunate people. "This wisdom" means that it is accomplished through constant experience. "Extremely subtle" is said because it is not the domain of coarse minds. As for "The center of the vajra, like space": "vajra" is the mind, because it is indestructible; "center" is the essence, because it is nonconceptual. Because it is pure by nature, it is like space. Because it is free from the dust of utter affliction, it is "dustless." Because all obscurations are fully pacified, it is "peaceful." Because it bestows the bliss of liberation whose nature is nonabiding, it "grants liberation." As for "that father": because he has become the very reality of the guru, he is "that father." "Is your own essence" is said because cause and result are indivisible.

This is the explanation of the twelfth chapter from The Source of Mindfulness, the commentary on the difficult points of the Hevajra composed by the master Kṛṣṇa.

Whatever great virtue has been gained
by bringing Hevajra to mind,
through it may the whole world, without exception,
be beautified with innate joy.

The second part of the King of Kalpas is complete.

This was translated, edited and finalized by the great Indian preceptor Glorious Moon and the great Tibetan translator Gö Lhetsé.

Translator's Notes

• Bhaga is left in Sanskrit, as the Tibetan leaves it; the commentary glosses it itself, first as the palace whose nature is wisdom and later as the E-shaped place where the awakening mind abides. In the etymology of Bhagavān, "conquest" renders Tibetan bcom pa, which here stands for Sanskrit bhaga: first as the term for the six excellences, then, derived from "breaking," as the vanquishing of the four māras. The remark that something "is given in the neuter gender" is a Sanskrit grammatical comment whose referent is not stated; it is translated as it stands.

"He is presented as a certain compiler" ('ga' zhig sdud pa por bstan pa) is terse; it appears to mean that the ever-present Buddha himself appears as the compiler. The Tibetan calls Nairātmyā and her companions rnal 'byor ba, "yoga practitioners"; since they are goddesses, "yoginīs" is used.

• "I am the expounder": the Tibetan here reads 'chang pa po ("holder"), evidently a slip for 'chad pa po ("expounder"), the word in the verse just quoted; translated accordingly. "Who is Vajrasattva?": su zhen is read as su zhe na ("if one asks who"). "Set forth": nye bar dgong pa is read as nye bar dgod pa ("presentation"); read as dgongs pa ("intention"), the sense is nearly the same. In the gloss on the root verse "Vajra is said to be indivisible," Tibetan rigs pa (normally "reasoning") renders Sanskrit yukti, which the commentator takes as "union," extending to sexual union (samāpatti). "Continuum" renders rgyud, which can mean either a mindstream or a tantra here. "The felling gaze": ltung ba here names one of the tantric gazes (pātana), not a transgression. "The Ḍākinī Vajra Net" is translated literally; it may refer to the Hevajra explanatory tantra known as the Ḍākinī Vajra Tent (Ḍākinīvajrapañjara).

• The verses explain the names of the thirty-two channels (nāḍī) listed in the root tantra. "Subtle" and "the one with form" explain the two halves of a single name, Sūkṣmarūpā. The Excellent One, the Sower, and the Universal One stand where the Sanskrit list has Divyā, Viṣṭā, and Śarvarī; because the Tibetan names diverge from or only loosely reflect those forms, they are translated by meaning. In the Bhāvakī verse the text reads dngos po mi brjod ("is not called existence"); since every verse names a channel, this is read as dngos po ma brjod ("is called She of Existence"). "It is also the cause of the yoginīs" reads rgyu ("cause") for the text's rgyud ("continuum"). "Inspired" renders dbugs dbyung ba (literally to give breath, hence to revive or encourage); its precise sense here is uncertain. "The vajra sciences" renders rdo rje gtsug lag, whose exact reference is unclear.

• The stanza naming the Measure and the Fair-Faced (Surūpiṇī) has three lines rather than four, so one of the two names lacks its own explanatory line; it is translated as it stands. The Measure stands where the root tantra's list of thirty-two channels has Pravaṇā; the Tibetan name ordinarily renders pramāṇa (measure, valid cognition), and since the commentator's Sanskrit cannot be confirmed, it is translated. The Tibetan name of the Desirous One (Kāminī) adds the words "of the wind"; they are kept. In the three cross-references to the third and fourth chapters, the term used elsewhere for the tantra in two parts designates its second part (this commentary's own colophons speak of "the first part," and the reference here to the eighth chapter carries no such qualifier), so it is rendered "the second part." The account of the origin lists only ignorance, formations, craving, and becoming, without grasping; it is translated as given. "Channel periods" renders a compound of "channel" and a unit of time, reflecting Sanskrit nāḍī, which names both a bodily channel and a period of the day.

• Here the Tibetan word rendered "the Fierce One" stands for Caṇḍālī, the inner fire of the root verse "Caṇḍālī blazes at the navel," not for the channel Caṇḍikā of the preceding piece; the gloss "because she is untouchable" plays on caṇḍālī, "outcaste woman." In the list of the fire's signs, the first item, written ngo ba, gives no sense and is read as dro ba, "warmth." In the rain rite, mnan paḥ is read as mnan par, "trampling." The explanation of "chapter" reflects the Sanskrit paṭala, read as a cloth (paṭa) that covers and protects, and as that which takes and holds. "The four watches" are divisions of the day and night, not meditation sessions.

• The quoted root line reads "the awakening of praise" (bstod pa), evidently a slip for "empty" (stong pa), as the commentary's own gloss on emptiness shows; it is translated accordingly. The clause on the two-armed, four-armed, and six-armed forms is compressed in the Tibetan (mchog ga is read as mchog gi, "of the supreme one"); it appears to present these forms as offspring of the principal deity, in keeping with the commentary's pairing of the causal Vajradhara with the resultant Heruka. As in the preceding piece, the commentator's term for the tantra in two parts is used here for its second part, and is rendered so.

• The Eternal One and the Jewel, among the crown ornaments of Gaurī and the others, are evidently Vairocana and Ratnasambhava, as the parallel list for the intermediate goddesses shows; they are translated as written. The goddess heading the four in the intermediate directions bears a Tibetan name that is not a standard rendering; she is identified as Pukkasī because Pukkasī heads the intermediate goddesses in the root tantra. "Demons" renders ma sangs, a class of spirits whose Sanskrit equivalent here cannot be confirmed. The "six families" are the buddha families, including that of Vajrasattva, not the six classes of beings.
• The romanized name glossed through "dispute" is the name this tantra gives to the buddha Amitābha. The epithet rendered "the self that contemplates reality" stands where the root verse names Sattva after Ārolika; the Tibetan may intend "being" (sems dpa') rather than "contemplating" (sems pa), but it is translated as written. In the gloss on dying, the commentary takes "dying" as the cessation of all activity of body, speech, and mind together with the winds, not physical death.
• "Scent" stands for excrement (the "great scent"); with the urine, blood, semen and flesh named next, it makes up the five nectars. In the closing verse, "completion" most likely means the completion stage, set against the diligence by which the form body is attained; the verse is terse and this reading is uncertain.
• □□□□□□□ is read as □□□□□□□□ ("untainted"), and □□□□□□□□□□□□□□ as □□□□□□□□□□□□□□ ("from the Joyous"), evident copyist's slips. The opening of the "Signs" chapter says, as the Tibetan stands, that the signs are "not the domain of those who have good fortune"; the sense expected is "of those without good fortune," and a negative may have dropped out. The gloss on "Banner" (□□□□□□□□) is obscure; it is taken as one who has been hanged. "The rite of severing the union" (□□□□□□□□□□□□□) appears to be the forceful rite that separates consciousness from the body, which the tantra treats later; the commentary restricts it to those who cannot otherwise be tamed and makes compassion its root. The twelve "kinds" are the stages of the path matched with the twelve classes of sacred site.
• □□□□□□□ ("deep"), in the list of what is eaten, the eating and the eater, is read as □□□□□□□□ ("of the eater"), as the parallel triad of object of offering, offerer and offering requires. In "whatever has the nature of speech", □□□□□ ("genuine") is read as □□□□□, since the gloss pairs body and speech with mudrā and mantra. In the lemma rendered "when one abides in the state of glorious Heruka", the syllable □□□□ is unclear; "state" is a tentative rendering, perhaps standing for Sanskrit pada. Picuvajra (□□□□□□□□□) is given as transliterated; I could not identify this figure or maṇḍala tradition with confidence. In the citation from The Manifest Awakening of Vairocana, □□□□□□□□□, rendered "as far as possible", could also be read "for as long as he lives". In "Vajrasattva does not come from any form at all", the phrase □□□□□□□□□□ is unclear as written, though the general sense is secure.
• In the lemma "Likewise again at the end of the joy of cessation," the Tibetan reads □□□□□□ ("endless"); since the commentary glosses □□□ ("end") and □□ ("again") separately, □□ is read for □□. In the lemma "It is known by oneself, from merit," the Tibetan reads □□□□□□□□□□ ("is called self"); the commentary's gloss ("is to be known, that is, experienced by oneself") shows the reading □□□□□□□□□□, which is followed. "Purity" (□□□□□□□□□□□), said of the third joy and of nirvāṇa, stands where the commentary's own list of the three joys has the joy of cessation (□□□□□□□□□□□□, viramānanda); it may be a scribal variant of that term, but it is translated as written. The channel called the Evil-Stirrer (□□□□□□□□□□□) could not be identified, so its name is translated literally.
• In the objection about things without mind, □□ is read as □□□, "grass", since the root verse speaks of stable and moving things and the objection calls them material forms without mind. □□□□□□□□□□□□□□ is read as □□□□□□□□□□□□□□, "emanates", the counterpart of "gathers in". In the verse on the wisdom seal, □□□□□□□□□□□□□□ may stand for □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, which would

give "the one bent on awakening gives up the woman". In "the body accomplished from the heart", □□□□ may be short for □□□□□□□□, which would give "accomplished from compassion", the usual counterpart of method.

• Here □□□□□□□ is caṇḍālī, the fire at the navel named in the root tantra. Its Sanskrit is Caṇḍālī, as in the Hevajra's lists of goddesses, so the earlier gloss Caṇḍikā for this name should read Caṇḍālī. "From the juncture" renders □□□□□□□, and which bodily point is meant is uncertain.

• In "Because it is the element of the Tathāgatas," the Tibetan has □□□□□□ ("skilled"). It is read as □□□ ("element"), the buddha-nature present in beings, since the gloss "the life of living beings" calls for it. In "finding awakening is not difficult," □□□□□ ("joy") is read as □□□□□ ("difficult"). "Things such as bells" translates □□□□□□□□□□□ as written, but it may stand for □□□□□□□□□□□□, "smells and the like", meaning the sense objects. The phrase translated "whose heart is entangled in all suffering" (□□□□□□□□□□□□□) is unclear, so that rendering is tentative.

• In the description of the fourth sign, the word as written means "examine." It is read as the similar-looking word for "constantly," which the sense requires. "Merely joy" presumably refers to the first of the four joys. The three set aside would then be joy, supreme joy, and the joy of cessation, leaving the innate. In the final section, the commentary glosses the line word by word, in the manner of a Sanskrit word analysis. "Vi" is a Sanskrit prefix, which it takes to mean "free from."

• In the eleventh chapter, the word otherwise rendered "view" means the yogic gazes (dṛṣṭi) taught in the Hevajra Tantra. These are fixed stares used in rites, such as the gaze that fells, so it is translated "gaze." The seven-times-born is a person who has been born as a human seven times in succession. The tantra teaches that eating a little of such a person's flesh gives the power of moving through the sky, and the commentary explains the signs by which he is recognized. "If even the ten virtues are treated as equal" is literal. It seems to mean that for one acting from great compassion even the distinction drawn by the ten virtues is set level, so nothing else need be mentioned.

• "The twelfth kalpa" renders rtog pa bcu gnyis pa, which could also mean a work "in twelve kalpas"; the text referred to is not identified.

"Having gained the authority to issue commands" renders bka' lung bsgo ba rnyed pa; it could also mean "having received the command," but the glosses that follow, on summoning and seizing gods, humans and asuras, favor the former.

In "one should practice that very awareness and the rest without interruption," rig pa may carry the technical sense of vidyā; the Tibetan is terse.

• In "the complete reversal of the continuum," rgyud has its sense of the mental continuum (saṃtāna), not "tantra."

"Destroyed by activity" renders 'jug pas brlag pa; 'jug pa (engagement, operation) is terse here and the sense is not certain.

• The quicksilver simile ends, as transmitted, "is not grasped" (gzung ba ma yin no). As a plain statement this would contradict the argument and the flower example that follows, so it is rendered as a rhetorical question, which gives the sense the passage requires. Lci ba, "something heavy," can also mean dung, the fuel used in alchemical heating.

The address "son of noble family" has no quotation marker; the lamp-and-darkness image echoes sūtra passages such as the Kāśyapaparivarta, and the address may belong to an unmarked quotation.

• In the gloss on "Just as for one seized by wind," the text reads mya ngan ("sorrow"), which makes no sense there; it is translated as myang na ("if one tastes"), which fits the bean remedy of the root verse.

"The bird's head" renders bya'i mgo bo literally; the commentary does not explain the expression.

The "tīrthikas of the buddhas" glosses the root verse's "Buddhist tīrthikas": the commentary

identifies them as followers of the śrāvaka and pratyekabuddha vehicles.

• Two lemmas carry evident copyists' slips and are translated by the reading the commentary's own glosses require: lan pa for len pa, "taking" (glossed as holding), and rnam sbyor ba, "joining," for rnam sbyong ba, "purifying" (glossed as making pure). In the list of preliminary empowerments, bdag po is taken as the lordship (adhipati) empowerment, and rig pa'i brtul zhugs las lung bstan pa as the knowledge observance followed by the prophecy (vyākaraṇa). In the section on the four transgressive injunctions, bsgral ba is deliverance in the ordinary sense (the claim to deliver beings who are by nature already in nirvāṇa is the "false statement"), not the wrathful rite; bud med is the common noun "woman" of "another's woman," identified with Nairātmyā, not the term rendered "Woman (Lalanā)" elsewhere in this text; and rgyud here is the mind-stream of beings, not a tantra.

• Line five of the medical verse reads slar ba, which names no taste or quality; it is read as sla ba, "thin," though a sour taste may have been intended. In the gloss on the five nectars the first lemma is the bare plural rnams, evidently cut from a longer word of the root verse, and is rendered "those"; the five lemmas pair the five nectars with the five Tathāgatas. "The self-born flower" (svayambhūkusuma) is the usual code term for menstrual blood. Tshad ma here is valid cognition (pramāṇa), not the name rendered "the Measure" elsewhere; likewise dngos po ma, thams cad ma and mtha' yas occur here only inside ordinary words (dngos po mtha' dag, thams cad mnyam par) and inside the name Amitābha, so those earlier names do not apply.

• In "There meat is eaten," sha za is the eating of meat, as the gloss shows, not the piśāca spirit. Two code words of the root song are read by their evident sense: gzhi mnyam as bzhi mnyam, "four equal parts" (catuḥsama, a perfume of four ingredients in equal measure), and tshong ma as tshod ma, "side dishes." The code go kud ha na names the five meats (cow, dog, elephant, horse and human). In "The corpse is to be placed there," ro may also mean "taste," and the gloss, that it enters the whole body, may intend that sense. Rin po che here is the jewel emblem of a buddha family, not the name rendered "the Jewel" elsewhere in this text.

• Three evident copyists' slips are translated by the reading the context requires: mi 'jigs pa, "fearless," is read as mi 'jig pa, "imperishable," since it glosses "inexhaustible"; in the definition of perception, 'jig pa, "destroying," is read as 'dzin pa, "apprehending," the standard definition of perception; and in the lemma rnal 'byor pa ni de yid bskyed, yid is read as yis, "by her," as the gloss and the next line (de yis) require. "She herself is the Blessed One" refers to wisdom as the Blessed Lady (Bhagavatī). Rtag pa here is the adjective "eternal," not the name rendered "the Eternal One" elsewhere.

• Sdom pa is glossed by the commentary itself as gathering all phenomena together, so it is rendered "binding" (saṃvara) rather than "vow." Tshad ma here is valid cognition (pramāṇa), not the name rendered "the Measure" elsewhere in this text; bud med in the quoted line is the common noun "woman," not the name rendered "Woman (Lalanā)," while the left channel appears here in its own Sanskrit form. Rgyud in this passage is the mind-stream of beings, not a tantra.

• The quotation introduced by "it has been said" echoes the well-known Avataṃsaka passage cited in the Ratnagotravibhāga commentary, that there is no being whom the Tathāgata's wisdom has not entered. Here the Tibetan says simply that no being is endowed with that wisdom; it is translated as it stands, though the sūtra, the concessive "yet," and the commentary's own later gloss ("not a single sentient being who is not of the nature of a buddha") suggest that a negative has dropped out in copying.

In the sentence on butchers, the Tibetan gives "the whole net of conceptual thought" with no verb of its own; "cut through" is supplied as the evident sense, a verb meaning "cut" having probably been lost before the following particle.

"Karma, affliction and birth" takes the phrase as the familiar threefold defilement; it could also be read as "the adventitious obscurations in which karma and afflictions arise."

• The rare expression rendered "Unruffled" (khrem gnyer med pa) is uncertain; it may mean "without frowning" or "free of agitation." "The supreme and the end" (mchog mtha') is taken as supreme joy and the joy of cessation, between which the reality being described is located. The gloss on "necklace" plays on Sanskrit hāra, "necklace," as what steals (harati) the mind.
• The text's sbal ba med pa ("frogless") is read as skal ba med pa, "those without fortune," which the context plainly requires; likewise spa bar bya ba is read as sba bar bya ba, "to be concealed."
• Two evident copyists' slips are corrected: bshad pa'i lam ("the explained path") is read as bshang ba'i lam, "the anus," where the burning needle is inserted; and snying rje'i sbyin pa ("the giving of compassion") is read as snying rje'i spyan, "the eyes of compassion," as the gloss on the eyes and the root line quoted after it require. In the variant reading "fully delivers from foes," the verb, ordinarily "to give," is glossed by the commentary as "to set apart"; "delivers" is used to carry both senses.
• In the first gloss on "the third of the second," the unintelligible ster is read as ste followed by the letter ra, giving "joined with ra." The code names chu ma, spos mo and lto chen ma are rendered literally as the Water Lady, the Fragrant Lady and the Great-Bellied Lady, since their Sanskrit equivalents could not be identified with confidence; the first may be Vāriyoginī. Both "inner dkar mo" and "inner ser mo" are rendered "the inner Gaurī," since both Tibetan words render Gaurī. In "After dharmāṇāṃ, O Vajra, supply," the word vajra is taken as an address; the line could also be read "the vajra gives."
• The text's ces zer ba ("what is called") is read as cher ser ba, "predominantly fair," on the pattern of the color glosses that follow it. The Indian preceptor's name, dpal ldan zla ba, is translated as Glorious Moon, since its Sanskrit form (perhaps Śrīcandra) could not be confirmed. "King of Kalpas" (kalparāja) is an epithet of the tantra; kalpa here means a section or part of the text, not an eon.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.